

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called 'The Questions of the Son of the Gods, Suvikrāntacinta'

Ārya-Suvikrāntacintādeva-putra-paripṛcchā-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 161 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ལྟ་བུ་བ་རྒྱ་སེམས་ཀྱི་ཞུ་བ་ཞེས་བྱ་བ་ཐག་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མཛན་པོ་

Toh 161 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in English as "The Questions of the Son of the Gods, Suvikrāntacinta," in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Suvikrāntacintādeva-putra-paripṛcchā, and in Tibetan as the Lha'i bu rab rtsal sems kyis zhus pa. As a paripṛcchā, or "questions" sūtra, it belongs to a well-established genre in which a divine or noble interlocutor poses questions to the Buddha, prompting teachings of broad doctrinal scope. The text is set at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, where the Buddha is surrounded by a vast assembly including monks, bodhisattvas drawn from many world-systems, gods of the desire and form realms, nāgas, and yakṣas, reflecting the cosmic grandeur typical of Mahāyāna scriptural settings. It is classified among the sūtras of the Kangyur and represents the tradition of canonical discourse addressed to an audience spanning both human and supramundane beings.

In the language of India:
Ārya-Suvikrāntacintādeva-putra-paripṛcchā-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra.

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called "The Questions of the Son of the Gods, Suvikrāntacinta."

First fascicle.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of twelve hundred monks, and with a great many hundreds of thousands of bodhisattvas gathered from other world-systems, and with sons of the gods who dwell in the desire realm and sons of the gods who dwell in the form realm, and with other sons of the gods as well, and with many retinues of nāgas headed by Sāgara the nāga king, and with many retinues of yakṣas headed by Kumbhīra the yakṣa king, and with many retinues of garuḍas headed by Mahābala the garuḍa king, and with many retinues of asuras headed by Rāhu the lord of asuras, and with many retinues of kinnaras headed by Drumaka the kinnara king, and with many retinues of great serpents

headed by Supraṭiṣṭhita the lord of great serpents, and with the four great kings together with their retinues, and with Śakra, lord of the gods, together with his retinue of many thousands of sons of the gods, and with Brahmā, lord of the realm of Brahma, together with his retinue of many hundreds of thousands of sons of the gods of the Brahma heavens, and with King Prasenajit together with his retinue of many thousands, and with the householder Anāthapiṇḍada together with his retinue — all assembled there at the same time. Surrounded on all four sides by these and other retinues, and with all eyes turned toward him, the Blessed One was teaching the Dharma.

At that time, Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful, was also present in that very assembly. And the son of the gods, the bodhisattva, the great being Suvikrāntacinta, who is irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, was likewise present in that assembly.

Then the son of the gods Suvikrāntacinta, perceiving that the great assembly had gathered, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee upon the ground, and with palms joined in the direction of the Blessed One, bowed and addressed the Blessed One in these words.

Blessed One, how are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who place no reliance on others in the Great Vehicle? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are firm in diligence in all that they undertake? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are distinguished by their merit? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who move through the world without attachment through their primordial wisdom? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are freed from darkness through their wisdom? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are free from fear in the midst of assemblies? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who rely upon meaning through what they have heard? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who rely upon the Dharma through the ways of the world? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who speak in accordance with what the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have declared? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who teach the Dharma to sentient beings? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are distinguished by their direct knowledges?

How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are difficult for all māras to subdue? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those whose depth is difficult to fathom by mind? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are unstained by the eight worldly concerns? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who

engage in what is profound and difficult to fathom? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are skilled in the faculties when teaching the Dharma? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who abide at the gateway of liberation through the unconditioned, unmixed with what is conditioned? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are skilled in cultivating tranquil discipline for the sake of cutting through overweening pride? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are skilled in the causes of all karmic deeds? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are free from all manner of views and skilled in dependent origination? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are skilled in the means by which they fully ripen sentient beings? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who accomplish ascetic discipline through utterly pure intention? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are free from a mind of enmity and endowed with the power of patience? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who have gone to the far shore of all perfections? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are the sustenance of all sentient beings? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those toward whom all the world comes to gather? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are praised by all living beings? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are without wound in all virtuous conduct? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are like an ocean in their wisdoms? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who have become sovereigns by wielding mastery over the Dharma? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who have become masters in all activities? How are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are without fault in any direction and who are endowed with qualities of every kind?

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the young god Rabjé Sem: Excellent, excellent, Rabjé Sem! It is indeed excellent of you to ask the Tathāgata on behalf of bodhisattvas, great beings — those who are supremely exalted above all the world, who are great guides of the world, who are endowed with great compassion, who have donned the armor since countless eons, whose diligence is utterly firm, who are great caravan leaders, who accomplish the welfare of immeasurable sentient beings, who are skilled in leading all immeasurable sentient beings to ease and happiness, and who are endowed with immeasurable qualities. Therefore, young god, listen well and hold it in mind, for I shall explain to you how those distinctive qualities of bodhisattvas, great beings, and others as well, are to be obtained.

The young god Rabjé Sem replied, So be it, Blessed One, and gave attention to the Blessed One. Then the Blessed One spoke these words:

Young god, if bodhisattvas, great beings, are endowed with four qualities, they are those who do not depend upon others in the Great Vehicle.

What are the four? Wisdom accomplished through skill in means, loving-kindness accomplished through great compassion, eloquence accomplished through mastery of meaning and Dharma, and the five higher knowledges accomplished through the branches of awakening. Young god, if bodhisattvas, great beings, are endowed with these four qualities, they are those who do not depend upon others in the Great Vehicle.

Concerning this, it is said:

One who accomplishes skill in means,
attaining direct wisdom and entering into realization,
and who, for the sake of refuge for all,
dwells in the vast expanse of great compassion,
thereby accomplishing loving-kindness —
one who becomes supremely skilled in meaning and Dharma,
gaining eloquence in the individual fields of knowledge,
and who, excelling through higher knowledges on the path of awakening —
such a one will not place reliance upon others.

Young god, if bodhisattvas, great beings, are endowed with four qualities, they are those who are steadfast in diligence in all undertakings. What are the four? Diligence that does not turn back, the discipline of pure intention, being endowed with fierce aspiration for awakening, and being endowed with a mind that does not grow weary of fully accomplishing the qualities of a buddha. Young god, if bodhisattvas, great beings, are endowed with these four qualities, they are steadfast in diligence in all undertakings.

Concerning this, it is said:

One whose diligence is firm and unwavering,
whose intention is undefiled and utterly pure,
whose aspiration for the sake of a buddha's gnosis is renowned,
who desires the qualities of a buddha and never grows weary —
one in whom these four vast and distinguished qualities are present
will arise with steadfastness on the path of awakening,
holding the branches of awakening as if in the palm of the hand,

and before long will become the Dharma king of the three worlds.

Young god, if bodhisattvas, great beings, are endowed with four qualities, they are those who are supremely exalted through pure merit. What are the four? Bodhisattvas who lead beings to the Perfection of Wisdom, who introduce those sentient beings that have not yet aroused the awakening mind so that they arouse it, who dedicate entirely across all three times as if like an emanation, and who, never parting from the awakening mind, strive to bring forth all roots of virtue. They are endowed with these four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

The wise who lead others to the Perfection of Wisdom,
who, having themselves entered awakening, cause others to take hold of the
awakening mind and enter it,
who, having entered awakening, rejoice in dedication across all three times,
inseparable from mind, like an emanation, causing others to aspire to
awakening —
whatever virtuous acts, however small, they perform,
they make all of them rest upon the mind oriented toward omniscience.

Young god, if bodhisattvas, great beings, are endowed with four qualities, they are those who act without attachment through gnosis. What are the four? Performing with understanding the actions of childlike beings yet not performing the deeds born of pride; knowing that all phenomena depend upon conditions, are without inherent blessing, and are devoid of any person; having emptiness as their domain while holding the intention never to abandon any sentient being; and having completely transcended all attachment, guarding full knowledge of the six sense sources. They are endowed with these four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Those who act with understanding are without pride,
skilled in dependent origination and free from views,
having emptiness as their domain yet not abandoning sentient beings,
having transcended all attachment, guarding what abides within and without
—
those who dwell most perfectly in these four supreme qualities
proceed to the far shore through wisdom and act without attachment.

Son of the gods, bodhisattvas, great beings, who are endowed with four qualities are those who are free from the darkness of ignorance. What are the four? Insatiable in learning and earnestly applying oneself to what is proper; teaching the Dharma with a mind free from material gain; individually examining all afflictions as though they were illusions, in order to know that the dharmadhātu is undivided; and by entering through a single mode, entering into the entry of all — these are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Insatiable in seeking learning, they understand what is proper;
they teach those teachings equally and do not seek material gain.
They see the clouds of affliction as illusions, as though a dream;
not separating the nature of reality, they enter through a single mode.
Relying on these four supreme qualities, great beings attain distinction
and, like a lamp of wisdom dispelling darkness, move through the world like
the moon.

Son of the gods, bodhisattvas, great beings, who are endowed with four qualities are those who are fearless in the midst of assemblies. What are the four? Attaining the dhāraṇī that holds all that is heard; attaining the eloquence that resolves the doubts of all sentient beings; great compassion that teaches selflessness to all sentient beings; and donning the armor of direct-knowledge wisdom that is free from māras and afflictions — these are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

They attain the dhāraṇī by which all that is heard is not wasted;
endowed with eloquence, they cut through the doubts of sentient beings.
With compassion they teach that all these dharmas are selfless,
and armored with the knowledge of direct perception, they are not weakened
by māras.
When bodhisattvas enter through these four qualities,
even going into the midst of every assembly, they have no fear.

Son of the gods, bodhisattvas, great beings, who are endowed with four qualities are those who rely on meaning when they hear teachings. What are the four? Because they do not cling to everything through learning, they are not attached to mere learning; completely abandoning all childish people whose practice has deteriorated; in order to perceive directly all pathways of letters, sounds, vocal expression, and words, thoroughly understanding them as being like an echo; and because they desire only meaning, seeking out

what is heard not in order to accumulate it and take delight in it for its own sake, they enter into the inexpressible meaning and not into the expressed meaning — these are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

No matter how much one hears, if one does not reflect on the meaning, a childish one, lacking learning, perpetually deteriorates in practice. Of all the sounds, echoes, melodies, and pathways of words in the three realms of existence, having heard the meaningful sound from them, like an echo, one understands the meaning itself, and does not engage in all manner of vices for delight and satisfaction.

This nature of reality is the supreme meaning and is inexpressible.

This is what arises from hearing meaning and sounds — one proceeds among beings, going out among them.

Son of the gods, bodhisattvas, great beings, who are endowed with four qualities are those who teach the Dharma according to worldly convention. What are the four? Teaching the Dharma to those engaged in conversation; rejoicing greatly in the great acts of generosity made in recollection of death by assemblies of common people gathered together, and dedicating those acts to awakening; and inclining toward solitude away from all commotion — these are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

When one has entered into the midst of many people, there the wise one should engage in Dharma talk.

To the assembled gatherings of many people, one should cultivate the perception of impending death.

Through this, being careful, the five types of generosity of others —

one should rejoice in those acts of generosity and dedicate them to awakening. And whenever one encounters commotion and bustle, one should then ardently wish to incline toward solitude.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they will be those who speak in accordance with what the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have declared. What are the four? Not abandoning the awakening mind; making the pursuit of learning into something essential; acting in accordance with what one has said; and entering into the natural selflessness of all things.

Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Even when brought low by hardship and harm, one does not abandon the awakening mind.

One makes the hearing and pursuit of the Dharma that protects beings essential.

With a mind at ease and in accord with instructions, one does exactly as one has said.

Those who are wise enter into the natural selflessness of all phenomena.

Striving in this way, the one endowed with knowledge will speak and act accordingly.

Ever diligent, not abandoning it — in harmony, there is no self whatsoever.

A garland of praises fair and constant will resound in all ten directions.

Thus those who teach the Dharma in this way are ennobled by the knowledge of Dharma.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they will be those who teach the Dharma to sentient beings. What are the four? Abiding in personal practice while teaching the Dharma to sentient beings; teaching the Dharma so that others may be tamed, guarded, freed, disciplined, and led to complete nirvāṇa, just as one has oneself been tamed, guarded, freed, disciplined, and fully passed beyond sorrow; having firm and certain resolve aimed at perfect and complete awakening for oneself, while also establishing sentient beings in the Great Vehicle; and desiring the Dharma oneself, and out of that same desire for Dharma, teaching it to others as well. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Making practice essential, one teaches the Dharma to beings.

Tamed, guarded, well-disciplined, dwelling in utter nirvāṇa, one leads those who are not yet tamed, not yet guarded, not yet disciplined, and who have not yet passed beyond sorrow to the wealth of the precious Dharma.

Their resolve toward the awakening mind becomes firm and certain, and one establishes beings in that same Vehicle.

Ever desirous of Dharma and full of purpose, one honors one's teacher, and to sentient beings one teaches the Dharma that accords with that.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they will be those who are exalted by the five superknowledges (abhijñā). What are the four? Dwelling again and again in the four divine abodes (brahmavihāra); constantly and continuously dwelling in deep solitude; attaining certainty through patience with the profound Dharma; and knowing body and mind to be in a state of perfect evenness. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Constantly and perfectly dwelling in the divine abodes,
one also cultivates joy in solitary dwelling.

Through knowledge one attains certainty from patience with the profound,
and one comes to possess a mind that is equal to space.

Thus those who strive ardently and are imperishable
become exalted through the five superknowledges.

They are as if seated in the presence of the buddhas themselves,
and they bring to full maturation the many sentient beings.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they will be those whom all māras find difficult to overcome. What are the four? The four meditative concentrations (dhyāna) cultivated in the aspect of emptiness; great compassion that does not abandon any sentient being; diligence that does not sever the lineage of the Three Jewels; and the six perfections (pāramitā) cultivated through skillful means. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

One who cultivates the four meditative concentrations determined by
signlessness and emptiness,
who always abides in compassion for the protection of all sentient beings,
who gains diligence that does not sever the continuity of the Three Jewels,
and who at all times, endowed with skillful means, engages in the six
perfections —

such a wise and learned one of great self-mastery, accomplished in this
practice,
truly transcends the four māras,
and places on the path to nirvāṇa those beings seized by the iron hook of
māra,
those wanderers who have no protector.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they will be those whom minds find difficult to fathom. What are the four? Entering into the manner of the profound Dharma; always being purposeful and yet difficult to approach; always being inspired and applying the mind to the Dharma; and comprehending with the mind the unobstructed wisdom of the buddhas. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

One who has entered into the manner of the profound Dharma,
who is always purposeful and yet has become difficult to approach,
who is always inspired and has entered into reflection on the Dharma,
and who comprehends with the mind —

such a skilled one, firmly established and abiding in the Great Vehicle,
becomes truly difficult for ordinary minds to fathom,
accomplishing the flawless wisdom that is free from attachment.
Therefore they are difficult for ordinary minds to fathom.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they will be those who are unstained by the eight worldly concerns. What are the eight? Not being puffed up by gain, pleasant words, praise, and happiness; not being cast down by loss, harsh words, blame, and suffering; fully making use of the aggregates (skandha) in order to bring sentient beings to maturation; and fully knowing the aggregates while preserving that knowledge and viewing them as solitary. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Even when they obtain gain, pleasant words, praise, and every happiness,
they never become puffed up by any of these.

Even when they encounter loss, harsh words, blame, and suffering,
they move through the world free from attachment, like a lotus.

To bring sentient beings to maturation they make full use of the aggregates,
knowing the aggregates to be like an illusion — like a granary empty of grain.
They move through the world for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings,
yet are unstained by the worldly concerns, fragrant with the perfume of moral discipline.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they will be those who practice what is difficult to fathom and profound. What are the four? The selflessness of the self; the absence of any sentient being in

sentient beings; the solitude of phenomena; and the absence of attachment in consciousness. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Fully knowing that the self is utterly without self,
following through the understanding that sentient beings are without any
sentient being,
fully knowing that phenomena are utter solitude,
and whose wisdom has no attachment, like a hand moving through space —
such courageous ones engage fully in what is profound,
and though there is nothing to practice, they are constantly practicing.
Utterly free from grasping, clinging, and all appropriation,
these purified beings are therefore difficult to fathom.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they
will be those who are skilled in the faculties of those to whom they teach the
Dharma. What are the four? Attaining higher knowledge (abhiññā); knowing the
individual perfect understandings (pratisaṃvid); keen wisdom; and the
complete purity of former aspirational prayers. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Having fully attained the higher knowledges,
with inexhaustible individual perfect understandings,
always possessed of keen wisdom, and having in former times
fully attained the complete purity of what was rightly accumulated —

Having fully understood the faculties of sentient beings,
they teach them the Dharma teachings that accord with those faculties.
The teaching of these is never without fruit —
and so, having passed beyond sorrow, they lead others to pass beyond sorrow
as well.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they
are those who have entered the gateway of liberation unmixed with the
conditioned. What are the four? Emptiness as their domain, and freeing
sentient beings bound by the bonds of wrong views; abiding in signlessness
and leading those who engage in conceptual thought fully beyond sorrow;
abiding in wishlessness and, for the sake of ripening sentient beings, taking
rebirth with full intention; and expertise in skillful means combined with the
definitive emergence of wisdom. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

With emptiness as their domain, they free those bound by wrong views,
abiding in signlessness they ripen these sentient beings.

Abiding in wishlessness, for the sake of ripening sentient beings,
they are born with intention, taking rebirth wherever they wish.

Grounded in wisdom and method they dwell at the gateway of liberation,
yet the sphere of the unconditioned they do not reach before its time.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they are those who are skilled in utterly refuting the conceited. What are the four? Thoroughly knowing the correct gateway within the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena; having confidence that all phenomena are without obscuration; fully knowing the afflictions that arise from the root of conceptual proliferation; and having no false pride toward all phenomena, since their nature is that of nirvāṇa. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

With mind settled in the dharmadhātu they have fully emerged,
and among these they will see no obscuration whatsoever.

Knowing that afflictions arise from the root of conceptual proliferation,
they do not on that account display conceited refutation.

All these phenomena are nirvāṇa by their very nature —
unborn, unceasing, pure by their own essential nature.

Those who, seeking omniscience, have gone to nirvāṇa,
are the ones who utterly refute the conceited.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they are those who are skilled in the causes of all karmic activity. What are the four? Not abandoning generosity, the cause of great wealth; not abandoning ethical conduct, the cause of rebirth in higher realms; not abandoning study, the cause of great wisdom; and not abandoning meditation, the cause of liberation. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Not abandoning generosity, the cause of great wealth, and its fruit;
attaining ethical conduct, the cause of rebirth in higher realms, and its fruit;
wisdom and the destruction of afflictions through study, and its fruit;
cultivating meditation, the cause of the knowledge of liberation, and its fruit —

those who are skilled, always striving in these four causes,
act day and night for the fruit of empowerment at the heart of awakening.

Son of the gods, if a bodhisattva, a great being, possesses four qualities, they are those who are free from all modes of wrong view and who are skilled in dependent origination. What are the four? Not asserting annihilation; not asserting eternalism; seeing that from ignorance arising, everything up to aging-and-death arises, while not holding it as a self; and seeing that from the cessation of ignorance, everything up to aging-and-death ceases, while not suppressing existence either. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Never falling into the view of permanence, never tumbling into annihilation —
by this one knows that phenomena arise through conditions and have no agent,

no experiencer, and are pure by their nature.

From the root of ignorance, all things up to aging-and-death arise —

— all the Victors have declared this: when that ceases, through the exhaustion of conditions, from that point onward arising no longer occurs.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is skilled in the means of ripening sentient beings to full maturation. What are the four? The bodhisattva regards all sentient beings as one to be depended upon; has no weariness in genuinely accumulating roots of virtue; thoroughly seeks the door of nirvāṇa by way of saṃsāra; and, through the means of inclination corresponding to whatever inclination sentient beings have, causes them to experience accordingly — and this is not through afflictions. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

This awakening of the buddhas rests upon sentient beings as its support;
cultivating virtue and the rest, there is no weariness in aspiration.

Thoroughly seeking nirvāṇa through the very door of saṃsāra,
one fully knows sentient beings' inclinations, each as they are, through skillful means.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is a sustainer of all sentient beings. What are the four? Inexhaustible wealth; inexhaustible teaching of the Dharma; the attainment of direct knowledge (abhiññā); and a mind that is level and equal like the earth. Those are the four

qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Their wealth is forever inexhaustible,

and they are forever like an inexhaustible ocean of Dharma.

Their five forms of direct knowledge are inexhaustible, constant, and unshaking;

ever mindful, their intention is like the earth.

Having entered rightly upon the path to peerless awakening,

those in whom these qualities abide while not yet having passed into nirvāṇa

—

they become sustainers of all beings,

and will swiftly and certainly emerge into supreme awakening.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is one toward whom the whole world will be drawn and assembled. What are the four? Abiding in the four divine abodes (brahmavihāras); gathering beings through the four means of attraction (saṃgrahavastus); knowing the Four Noble Truths; and attaining the four analytical knowledges (pratisaṃvids). Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Abiding by means of the four divine abodes,

ever delighting in the means of attraction,

those fearless heroes with respect to the four truths —

beings will portray them and pay them homage.

Having reached the far shore of the four analytical knowledges,

always striving in holding and reciting the teachings,

and bringing joy to those on the far shore through the bliss of well-being —

for this reason they become pleasing and beloved.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities will be praised by all living creatures. What are the four? Being endowed with learning and moral discipline, without pretense; being pleasant to associate with; delighting in solitude and guarding the sense faculties; having no excessive attachment to one's own comfort, and always attending to what is blameworthy. Those are the four qualities.

Concerning this, it is said:

Having obtained the quality of learning and reached the far shore of moral discipline,
without pretense, ever maintaining fine conduct in that way;
dwelling in forests and forest glades, restraining the sense faculties,
mindful, not looking to one's own comfort, attending to what is blameworthy —
whoever always possesses such virtuous qualities,
those ones always strive for the benefit of sentient beings,
those ones always act for the welfare of sentient beings,
and those ones always incline their minds toward awakening.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is one who is not disparaged in any virtuous conduct. What are the four?

They are ones possessed of excellent faith, possessed of excellent diligence, possessed of great compassion, and skilled in dedicating all things to the Great Vehicle. These, then, are the four. And concerning this it is said:

They are endowed with faith and steadfast in restraint,
possessed of the force and power of diligence.

They bear great loving-kindness and compassion toward all beings,
and are skilled in dedicating everything to awakening.

Therefore they are not disparaged in any virtuous conduct,
and like the moon in the fifteenth night among the host
of stars in the sky, dwelling there in all their splendor,
they shall grow and flourish in every virtue, again and again.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is one who is like an ocean in wisdom. What are the four? Acting in accordance with what one has proclaimed; making one's practice the very essence; the mind being firmly settled; and having an intention resolute as a vajra. These, then, are the four. And concerning this it is said:

Those skilled ones act in accordance with what they have proclaimed.

They make their practice the very essence and are firmly settled in mind.

Those who are diligent will come to be endowed
with an intention steadfast as a vajra.

Those skilled ones who teach these four qualities
always rely on virtuous spiritual friends,
will make the essence of what they have pledged,
and always uphold the words of the buddhas.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is one who, by mastering Dharma, has become a sovereign lord. What are the four? Being possessed of the power of wisdom and not being possessed of the power of afflictions; mastering the mind and not being mastered by māra; being excellently endowed with dhāraṇī and eloquence; and teaching the Dharma in a fruitful manner. These, then, are the four. And concerning this it is said:

They are possessed of the power of wisdom and do not fall under the sway of afflictions.

By the power of wisdom they are free from all foolish views.

They master the mind, have abandoned the four māras,
are firm in eloquence, and are undisturbed through dhāraṇī.

Whatever they teach does not fail to bear fruit.

Therefore they swiftly come to be endowed with true sovereignty.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is one who has become a teacher in all activities. What are the four? Freedom from arrogance; reverence toward the preceptor; conscientiousness; and keen aspiration. These, then, are the four. And concerning this it is said:

Free from arrogance and abiding in reverence toward the preceptor,
thoroughly conscientious and with fierce aspiration for supreme awakening,
aspiring with sincere intention and ever guided aright —
such a one, a teacher beyond compare, is always a true teacher.

Those skilled in worldly and transcendent matters,
steadied through knowledge of what is proper and what is not,
who have grasped within themselves the good of all the world's friends —
to such a one all beings bow with joined palms to the crown of the head.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva, a great being, who possesses four qualities is one who is without any fault in all respects and is possessed of every excellence. What are the four? Cherishing beings by means of the wisdom of direct knowledge; the eloquence of the intention of all buddhas; being inseparable from all virtue and free from habitual tendencies; and being endowed with all virtuous qualities and having attained empowerment. These, then, are the four. And concerning this it is said:

They cherish sentient beings, purified and vast, through their knowledge of direct knowledge.

They are endowed with the sky-like eloquence of the intention of all the Sugatas.

With diligence unhindered, abandoning all non-virtue and habitual tendencies, endowed with virtue and having attained empowerment — those who are perfectly established in these qualities are possessed of excellence that is without any fault.

When the Blessed One taught this demonstration of the fourth point, two hundred and twenty thousand sentient beings from among gods and humans aroused the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Twenty-five thousand bodhisattvas attained the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti). From among the beings of gods and humans, one hundred thousand sentient beings obtained the eye of Dharma with regard to phenomena — pure, stainless, and undefiled. This great trichiliocosm trembled and shook in six ways, and the entire world was suffused with a great radiance. The gods caused a rain of divine flowers to fall and the sounds of divine cymbals arose. The nāgas likewise caused a rain of red pearls and nāga flowers to fall. The asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, and yakṣas offered divine offerings to the Blessed One. The entire assembly, fully gathered, called out three times with great deliberateness: "Wondrous is the Dharma! Wondrous is the Dharma! Wondrous is the Dharma!" And they performed great acts of offering.

Then the god's son Rabtsal spoke to youthful Mañjuśrī in these words: "Mañjuśrī, please request the Blessed One to teach the definitive analysis of the meaning and words of those thirty-two qualities. And Mañjuśrī, you too should be confident in expounding the definitive analysis of the meaning and words of those thirty-two qualities."

"Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who do not rely upon others in the Great Vehicle?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, are not led along by the conditions of others — that is when, god's son, bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who do not rely upon others in the Great Vehicle."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those whose diligence is steadfast in all their undertakings?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who decisively overcome all mental afflictions — that is when, god's son, bodhisattvas, great beings, are those whose diligence is steadfast in all their undertakings."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are supremely distinguished by their merit?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who fully realize the dharmadhātu as immovable — that is when, god's son, bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are supremely distinguished by their merit."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who conduct themselves without attachment in wisdom?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who do not become attached to any object whatsoever — that is when, god's son, bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who conduct themselves without attachment in wisdom."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are free from the darkness of ignorance?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, know all phenomena to be utterly pure by their intrinsic nature — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are free from the darkness of ignorance."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are without fear in the midst of assemblies?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, analyze all phenomena and find nothing — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are without fear in the midst of assemblies."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who rely on meaning rather than on what they have heard?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, know all phenomena to be inexpressible — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who rely on meaning rather than on what they have heard."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who rely on the Dharma in accordance with the ways of the world?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, know the dharmadhātu itself to be peace — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who rely on the Dharma in accordance with the ways of the world."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who speak in accordance with what the buddha Blessed Ones have declared?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, do not rely on any sound whatsoever — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who speak in accordance with what the buddha Blessed Ones have declared."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who teach the Dharma to sentient beings?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, turn away from all speech — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who teach the Dharma to sentient beings."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are supremely exalted by means of direct knowledge (abhijñā)?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, do not stir from any phenomenon whatsoever — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are supremely exalted by means of direct knowledge."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are difficult for all māras to overcome?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, in order to realize emptiness, thoroughly seek to understand that affliction itself is awakening — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are difficult for all māras to overcome."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those whose depth is difficult to fathom by mind?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, fathom the depth of all buddha qualities — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those whose depth is difficult to fathom by mind."

The god's son said:

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are unstained by the eight worldly concerns?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, move about in the world yet do not become stained by worldly concerns — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are unstained by the eight worldly concerns."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who engage in what is deep and difficult to fathom?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, do not become despondent on account of there being no self in the self — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who engage in what is deep and difficult to fathom."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are skilled in the faculties through their teaching of the Dharma?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, regard all the faculties through the six faculties — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are skilled in the faculties through their teaching of the Dharma."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who abide at the gateway of liberation unmixed with the conditioned?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, teach liberation through every gateway — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who abide at the gateway of liberation unmixed with the conditioned."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are skilled in the gradual practice of composure for the purpose of cutting through superior arrogance?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, seek and look toward nirvāṇa from within saṃsāra, and equally seek and look toward saṃsāra from within nirvāṇa — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are skilled in the gradual practice of composure for the purpose of cutting through superior arrogance."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are skilled in the cause of all karmic activity?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, regard all phenomena as unchanging — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are skilled in the cause of all karmic activity."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are free from all manner of views and skilled in dependent origination?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, come to know all phenomena as having no owner — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are free from all manner of views and skilled in dependent origination."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are skilled in means for the purpose of ripening sentient beings?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, do not disparage the ways of the world — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are skilled in means for the purpose of ripening sentient beings."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who have accomplished the ascetic observances through the complete purification of intention?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, come to know that realization itself is awakening — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who have accomplished the ascetic observances through the complete purification of intention."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are free from a vengeful mind and possessed of the power of patience?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, come to know and see that all phenomena have forever passed beyond sorrow — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are free from a vengeful mind and possessed of the power of patience."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who have gone to the far shore of all the perfections?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, see all phenomena as being on the far shore — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas,

great beings, are those who have gone to the far shore of all the perfections."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are a refuge and support for all sentient beings?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, fully realize the inexhaustible basic space of phenomena (dharmadhātu) — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are a refuge and support for all sentient beings."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those toward whom all the world will be gathered?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, illuminate all buddha-fields in the manner of non-appearance — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those toward whom all the world will be gathered."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who will be praised by all living creatures?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, neither take up nor abandon any phenomenon whatsoever — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who will be praised by all living creatures."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are without reproach in all virtuous conduct?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, come to know that all phenomena are alike and equal to space — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are without reproach in all virtuous conduct."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who have become the very essence of wisdom?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, make no distinctions whatsoever within the basic space of phenomena — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who have become the very essence of wisdom."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who have become sovereign through mastery over phenomena?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, by contemplating the inconceivable come to know all minds —

— those, god's son, are the bodhisattvas, great beings, who have become sovereign through mastery over phenomena.

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who have become masters in all activities?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, come to know all modes through a single mode, and come to know a single mode through all modes — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who have become masters in all activities."

The god's son said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way are bodhisattvas, great beings, those who are entirely without fault and possessed of all qualities?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, when bodhisattvas, great beings, having realized that all phenomena have no antidote, neither establish any phenomenon nor eliminate any phenomenon — that, god's son, is when bodhisattvas, great beings, are those who are entirely without fault and possessed of all qualities in every respect."

When the youthful Mañjuśrī had taught this teaching, fifty-eight thousand bodhisattvas attained the patient acceptance of the prophecy of non-arising. Seventy-two thousand among the multitude of gods and humans obtained the Dharma-eye, pure and unstained, free from all defilement, regarding all phenomena. More than a hundred thousand living beings gave rise to the mind set upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And the gods released showers of divine flowers from the sky above in offering to the youthful Mañjuśrī. The members of the entire assembly, having heard this teaching of the youthful Mañjuśrī, arose in delight, joy, and happiness, and spoke these words: "May we too attain those Dharmas! May we too attain an eloquence of the same quality as the indomitable eloquence of the youthful Mañjuśrī!" The Blessed One also spoke these words to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, this teaching of the definitive analysis of the Dharma that you have set forth has been excellently spoken. Excellent! Excellent!"

The second section.

Then the god's son Prabalacetas addressed the youthful Mañjuśrī and said: "Mañjuśrī, do you desire from me a shelter of the Dharma?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "God's son, that you say, 'Do you desire a shelter of the Dharma?' — god's son, in this well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, what is called a shelter of the Dharma is the abandonment of craving and desire. This Dharma is without desire, because it is without individual discernment. This Dharma is invisible, because it has entirely transcended the range of the eye. This Dharma is unmade, because it has no established existence. This Dharma is unseen, because it is unmixed with the six sense-objects. This Dharma has no owner, because it is free from mind, mentation, and consciousness. This Dharma is ungrasped, because it is nowhere definitively established. This Dharma is without ground, because it proceeds to an object that is no-object. This Dharma is undefiled, because it is secluded by its very nature. This Dharma has no coming, because its past limit is utterly pure. This Dharma has no going, because its future limit is utterly pure. This Dharma has no abiding, because what arises in the present is utterly pure. This Dharma is without exertion, because it is free from investigation and elimination. This Dharma is without an equal, because it is equal to space.

This Dharma is without equal and without non-equal, because it has no antidote. This Dharma is unshaken, free from conceit, unexamined, unanalyzed, unestablished, and nowhere demonstrated, because it has utterly transcended every domain of māra. This Dharma is without taking up and without setting down, because it is free from arising and ceasing. This Dharma abides in non-abiding, because it inclines wholly into the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena. This Dharma is undivided, because it has never truly come about. This Dharma has no thorough activity, because it is free from conceptual elaboration. This Dharma is free from conceptual elaboration, because it is inherently at peace. This Dharma is utterly at peace, because it is free from all conceptual thought. This Dharma is without any continual arising, because it has decisively overcome every opposing argument. This Dharma is supremely exalted, because it is free from the dust of attachment to desirable things. This Dharma is without emptiness, because it is emptiness. This Dharma is without signs, because it has never been definitively determined. This Dharma is without aspiration, because consciousness finds no footing within it. This Dharma is without abiding, because its root has been utterly severed. This Dharma is without support, because it has no companion. This Dharma is immovable, because it is without support. This Dharma is without a self, because it is primordially pure. This Dharma is without a sentient being, because no sentient being has ever been definitively established. This Dharma

is without permanence, because it has never come forth from the very beginning. This Dharma has not arisen, because it was never born from the very beginning. This Dharma is unborn, because it is free from defining characteristics. This Dharma is without defining characteristics, because it is free from all defining characteristics. This Dharma is at peace, because it has been cut off from the very beginning. This Dharma is without any cutting off, because it has been inherently at peace from the very beginning. And since this Dharma is neither divisible nor manifest, it is like the nature of space.

Son of the gods, for a Dharma such as this, there is such a thing as honoring the Dharma. The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, the way of honoring this Dharma is without any spreading about. Mañjuśrī replied: Excellent, son of the gods, excellent! It is exactly as you have said. The way of honoring this Dharma is one in which there is no defilement of body, speech, or mind. Why is that? Because this Dharma is clear and unturbid, it cannot be honored by a turbid mind.

The son of the gods asked: Mañjuśrī, what constitutes a turbid mind? Mañjuśrī replied: Son of the gods, a mind that recollects the buddha by following after the sign of form is a turbid mind. A mind that recollects the Dharma by way of sound, voice, melody, and the path of words is a turbid mind. A mind that recollects the Saṅgha by making the attainment of fruits manifest is a turbid mind. A mind that recollects the complete abandonment of afflictions is a turbid mind. A mind that recollects the gods by relying on rebirth is a turbid mind. A mind of giving that has not been tamed is a turbid mind. A mind of moral discipline that has not been pacified is a turbid mind. A mind of patience that depends on sentient beings is a turbid mind.

A mind of wisdom accompanied by conceptual elaboration is a turbid mind. A mind of loving-kindness that abides in grasping at a self is a turbid mind. A mind of meditative concentration that has not definitively examined the mind is a turbid mind. A mind of compassion that is filled with doubt is a turbid mind. A mind of joy that is divorced from the path to nirvāṇa is a turbid mind. A mind of equanimity that abides in duality is a turbid mind. A mind of feeling that perceives a body is a turbid mind. A mind of close mindfulness that perceives phenomena as things is a turbid mind. A mind of right striving that perceives arising and ceasing is a turbid mind. A mind of the bases of miraculous power that relies on body and mind is a turbid mind. A mind of the five faculties that relies on the six sense faculties is a turbid mind. A mind of the five powers that is accompanied by the power of views is a turbid mind. A

mind of the limbs of awakening that abides in the perception of phenomena as things is a turbid mind. A mind that cultivates the path by striving in the mental application of formations is a turbid mind. A mind that has the perception of thoroughly examining suffering is a turbid mind. A mind that has the perception of meditating upon the origin of suffering is a turbid mind. A mind that perceives cessation as exhaustion is a turbid mind. A mind that has the perception of meditating upon the path is a turbid mind. To whatever extent one superimposes upon what is by nature utterly pure, to that same extent the mind is turbid.

The young god said: Mañjuśrī, what then are the minds that are without turbidity?

Mañjuśrī replied: Young god, those minds are the ones that are equal to space.

The young god said: Mañjuśrī, is there even the slightest mind in space?

Mañjuśrī replied: Young god, just as there is no mind in space, so too the mind is like that. Whoever has such a mind — that is a mind equal to space.

The young god said: Mañjuśrī, who could possibly aspire to that state?

Mañjuśrī replied: Young god, it is difficult for those who strive with exertion to aspire to it.

The young god said: Mañjuśrī, what exactly is this so-called striving with exertion?

Mañjuśrī replied: Young god, it is striving with exertion precisely because the mind is equal to space.

The young god said: Mañjuśrī, what does one do with exertion?

Mañjuśrī replied: Young god, making something permanent is striving with exertion. Making something impermanent is striving with exertion. In the same way, making something pleasant or painful, attractive or unattractive, self or selfless — that is striving with exertion. Calling something empty, calling something a person — that is striving with exertion. Calling something signless, calling something wishless — that is striving with exertion. Positing, expressing, engaging with, and teaching phenomena by way of similes drawn close — illusion, dream, optical illusion, reflection, echo, the moon in water, mirage, and magical emanation — that is striving with exertion. To whatever extent one posits phenomena, to that same extent it is striving with exertion. Finding fault in affliction and finding no fault in purification — that is striving

with exertion. Seeing fault in saṃsāra and seeing virtue in nirvāṇa — that is striving with exertion. Young god, these are the forms of striving with exertion belonging to those who are proud of their exertion.

The young god said:

The young god said: "Mañjuśrī, what then is the absence of superior pride?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Young god, one who has realized the sphere of definite emergence, who has accomplished the cessation of all afflictions, yet who neither abides by cessation nor causes cessation to cease, who neither produces non-arising nor is terrified by any sound — one who knows that the very intrinsic nature of complete defilement is itself the intrinsic nature of complete purification, and who thereby attains, with respect to all phenomena, freedom from duality, freedom from anything to be adopted, and freedom from anything to be discarded: young god, that is the absence of superior pride."

When Mañjuśrī the youthful had taught this discourse, the Dharma-eye of twenty-two thousand young gods, with respect to phenomena, became pure and stainless, free from dust. Five thousand monks, through non-clinging, gained liberation of mind from all defilements. Twenty-two thousand bodhisattvas attained patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena. Many hundreds of thousands of living beings generated the mind of awakening oriented toward unsurpassed, perfectly complete enlightenment. A thousand laymen also obtained the Dharma-eye with respect to phenomena, pure and stainless, free from dust. Two thousand women, both householders and those who had gone forth, also obtained the Dharma-eye with respect to phenomena, pure and stainless, free from dust.

Then the young god Ratnacandra addressed those great śrāvakas, saying: "Venerable ones, whatever doubts you have, ask them of Mañjuśrī the youthful."

Thereupon the elder the great Kāśyapa addressed Mañjuśrī the youthful thus: "Mañjuśrī, when a monk meditates on the eight liberations, on what does he meditate?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Kāśyapa, when a monk meditates on the eight liberations, he meditates on what is without root, without limit, without abiding place; he meditates on what is undisturbed; he meditates on what is perfect."

The great Kāśyapa said: "Mañjuśrī, on the basis of what reasoning do you say this?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Kāśyapa, the root is one's own body. The limit is ego-grasping. The abiding place is the three realms. Disturbance is the afflictions. The unequal is duality. Accordingly, one knows the body to be without root; one knows ego-grasping to be without limit; one knows the three realms to be without abiding place; one knows the afflictions to be undisturbed; one knows the meditative absorptions to be non-dual. It is for this reason, venerable Kāśyapa, that I say that when a monk meditates on the eight liberations, he meditates on what is without root, without limit, without abiding place, meditates on what is undisturbed, and meditates on what is perfect."

Śāriputra said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva endowed with unattached wisdom?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, a bodhisattva who engages in all attachments and yet is not stained by any attachment, who manifests all the afflictions directly and yet, for the sake of bringing sentient beings to full maturation, does not abandon those afflictions in accordance with their own intrinsic nature — to that extent a bodhisattva is endowed with unattached wisdom."

The great Maudgalyāyana said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one of great miraculous power?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Maudgalyāyana, a bodhisattva who neither attains what is conditioned nor attains what is unconditioned —

and also disciplines those who are in training and those who are beyond training — to that extent a bodhisattva is one of great miraculous power.

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, how does a bodhisattva abide free from afflictions?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Subhūti, when a bodhisattva knows all phenomena to be without obscuration, is free from both the far shore and the near shore, neither abandons the obscurations to awakening nor rises from meditative absorption, and yet manifests all activities — to that extent a bodhisattva abides free from afflictions.

Gāṅgaputra said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva a teacher of the Dharma?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Gāṅgaputra, when a bodhisattva teaches the Dharma fruitfully through all faculties, with the teaching that all formations are impermanent, and over thousands of eons teaches it extensively through meaning, through words, and through letters, and yet it never comes to an end — to that extent a bodhisattva is a teacher of the Dharma.

Nāmāgra said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one of meditative concentration?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Nāmāgra, when a bodhisattva knows that all phenomena are in their very nature in a state of meditative equipoise, gives rise to great compassion toward those whose minds are scattered, and acts all the way to the furthest limit of the final end, yet does not waver from abiding in meditative concentration — to that extent a bodhisattva is one of meditative concentration.

Upāli said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who holds the Vinaya?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Upāli, when a bodhisattva knows that phenomena are perpetually tame in their very nature, is personally free from transgressions and afflictions, and yet also teaches the Dharma for the purpose of disciplining transgressions and afflictions, thereby both penetrating the afflictions and seeking awakening — to that extent a bodhisattva is one who holds the Vinaya.

Aniruddha said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva endowed with the divine eye?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Aniruddha, when a bodhisattva sees all visible forms appearing in the ten directions, and through seeing forms as empty comes to realize in full accord that all phenomena are empty — to that extent a bodhisattva is endowed with the divine eye.

Bakula said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who guards the sense faculties?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "When a bodhisattva regards all sense-objects as buddha-objects, and regards even buddha-objects as objectless — to that extent a bodhisattva is one who guards the sense faculties.

Aṅgulimāla said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one of keen faculties?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "When a bodhisattva, because awakening is not arisen by its intrinsic nature, regards it as equal to the uninterrupted transgressions — to that extent a bodhisattva is one of keen faculties.

Mahākātyāyana said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva skilled in analyzing the sūtras?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Mahākātyāyana, when a bodhisattva has obtained the four inexhaustible analytical knowledges (pratisaṃvid), expounds and teaches extensively through even a single word for the duration of a hundred thousand eons, and yet does not in any way abandon the afflictions through that —

— and does not take up purification, and teaches in this way; and does not stir from the abiding of the nature of reality, and yet does not rely on any abiding place — teaching in this way: to that extent a bodhisattva is skilled in analyzing the sūtras."

Mahākauṣṭhila said: "Mañjuśrī, how does a bodhisattva obtain the four analytical knowledges (pratisaṃvid)?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "When a bodhisattva demonstrates analytical knowledge of meanings by means of the inexpressible meaning; demonstrates analytical knowledge of phenomena by means of abiding in the dharmadhātu itself; demonstrates analytical knowledge of definitive words by means of the absence of names and signs; and demonstrates analytical knowledge of eloquence by means of equality with an echo — to that extent a bodhisattva has obtained the four analytical knowledges."

Rāhu said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva endowed with moral discipline?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Rāhu, when a bodhisattva has perfectly taken up moral discipline and the vows of ascetic practice, and then, for the sake of ripening sentient beings, goes to wherever those beings are whose conduct transgresses moral discipline — to that extent a bodhisattva is endowed with moral discipline."

Ānanda said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one of great learning?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Ānanda, when a bodhisattva listens to and hears what all the buddhas have taught, and also comprehends the meaning of everything heard, retains it just as it was heard, and teaches it just as it has been retained — to that extent a bodhisattva is one of great learning."

Then the divine youth Ratnacūḍa spoke to those great śrāvakas as follows: "Venerable ones, do any of you possess even some of the qualities of this kind that the youthful Mañjuśrī has set forth?"

They replied: "Divine youth, we do not possess even a single one of those qualities."

The divine youth said: "Venerable ones, in that case, would you not fail to be supreme among great śrāvakas?"

Śāriputra said: "Divine youth, it is like this: just as, compared to a dark pool, a superior pond is supreme, so too, compared to other śrāvakas, we ourselves are supreme. And it is like this: just as, compared to the great ocean, the mass of water below is supreme, so too a bodhisattva is supreme compared to all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas."

The divine youth said: "Venerable Śāriputra, that has been taught by śrāvakas who are without manifest conceit. Excellent! Excellent!"

Mañjuśrī said: "Divine youth, it is indeed so. Śrāvakas are without superior conceit. Bodhisattvas are possessed of superior conceit."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, on what basis do you say this?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, it is like this: śrāvakas have abandoned conceit in dependence on pratyekabuddhas; but a bodhisattva is possessed of superior conceit, and through that conceit perfectly accomplishes the qualities of a buddha. Therefore a bodhisattva is possessed of superior conceit."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, one who is possessed of superior conceit praises oneself and disparages others. Would a bodhisattva not become like that as well?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, it is so: a bodhisattva does praise oneself and disparage others."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, on what basis do you say this?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Divine youth, a bodhisattva proclaims in many ways the praise of the Great Vehicle and proclaims that the vehicle of the śrāvakas is not worthy of that praise. Thinking 'How may sentient beings arouse the mind of awakening?', the bodhisattva proclaims the qualities of his own path, and thinking 'Let no one develop a mind that delights in this lesser thing,' turns away from the Lesser Vehicle with aversion. Therefore, divine youth, a bodhisattva praises the Great Vehicle and disparages the vehicle of the śrāvakas."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, would a bodhisattva not thereby incur a transgression?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, if someone were to speak without praise of a mere glass bead and instead proclaim the praise of a precious jewel of beryl, would that person incur a transgression?"

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, that would not be so."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, likewise, a bodhisattva who proclaims the praise of the Great Vehicle and proclaims that the vehicle of the śrāvakas is not worthy of that praise incurs no transgression. Consider this analogy, divine youth: if a man of extraordinary strength were to proclaim the praise of a wheel-turning king and say the same was not fitting of a regional king, would that be worthy of blame?"

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, that would not be so."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, likewise, a bodhisattva who praises the Great Vehicle and disparages the vehicle of the śrāvakas is not worthy of blame."

Then the Blessed One uttered an expression of approval to youthful Mañjuśrī, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, Mañjuśrī! Those words of yours are well spoken. Mañjuśrī, one who proclaims the praise of the Great Vehicle proclaims the praise of all vehicles. Why is that? Because all vehicles arise from it as their source."

Then another divine youth, named Rabrtsal Sems (Keen-Minded), spoke these words to youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, in dependence on what does a bodhisattva arouse the mind of awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, a bodhisattva arouses the mind of awakening in dependence on the afflictions of all sentient beings."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, why does a bodhisattva arouse the mind of awakening in dependence on the afflictions of all sentient beings?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, if the afflictions of sentient beings were not the vehicle of awakening, then a bodhisattva, having aroused the mind of awakening, would not put on the armor. "

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, on what does the mind of awakening rest?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, the mind of awakening rests on all the qualities of a buddha. Why is that? Because all the qualities of a buddha arise in dependence on the mind of awakening as their root."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, on what do all phenomena rest?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, all phenomena rest in the abiding place of having no root. Why is that? Because all phenomena are boundless, and therefore without root, and yet are expressible and rest upon space."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, how many are the qualities of a buddha?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Divine youth, the qualities of a buddha are as many as all phenomena are many. Why is that? Because the Tathāgata has awakened to all phenomena — therefore, divine youth, just as all phenomena are many, so too are the qualities of a buddha that many."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, does that mean that attachment, aversion, and delusion are also qualities of a buddha?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, that is indeed so — attachment, aversion, and delusion are also qualities of a buddha. Why is that? Because awakening to the root ground of those very afflictions is what is taught to be a buddha."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, is there some category by which all sentient beings will become buddhas?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, it is by being without category that all sentient beings will become buddhas — not by means of any category. Why is that? Because the Tathāgata has realized and fully comprehended all sentient beings."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, how has he realized and fully comprehended them?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, by the aspect of there being no sentient beings, and by the aspect of emptiness."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, what does emptiness realize?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, if emptiness were to realize even the slightest thing, it would no longer be emptiness. Why is that? Because, divine youth, emptiness is free of conceptual thought and free of striving."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, did not the Tathāgata declare that the realization of emptiness is awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, emptiness itself is awakening — and precisely because of that, the Blessed One also declared that the very realization of emptiness is awakening."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, one who abides in emptiness — in what does one abide?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, one who abides in emptiness does not abide in desire, in form, or in the formless. One does not abide in the aggregates, elements, or sense bases. One does not abide in body or in mind. Why is that? Because, divine youth, the very abiding by which one would come to abide is itself empty — and so emptiness does not abide in emptiness."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, does the Tathāgata not abide by abiding in ultimate emptiness?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, the Tathāgata himself is emptiness, and emptiness is non-dual — therefore the Tathāgata abides by the abiding of non-duality."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the abiding of non-duality?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, the abiding of non-duality is simply non-duality itself — there is no other abiding in it. That its abiding is nothing other than non-duality is itself non-duality."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, what is meant by 'two,' and what is meant by 'non-dual'?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, attachment and what one makes to be free of attachment — that is two. The intrinsic nature of attachment is non-dual. Aversion and what one makes to be free of aversion — that is two. The intrinsic nature of aversion is non-dual. Delusion and what one makes to be free of delusion — that is two. The intrinsic nature of delusion is non-dual. Affliction and what one makes to be free of affliction — that is two. The intrinsic nature of affliction is non-dual. Self and what one makes to be no-self — that is two. The intrinsic nature of self is non-dual."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the intrinsic nature of self?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Divine youth, the intrinsic nature of self is primordially pure, and for that reason it is selflessness itself. The intrinsic nature of self, being primordially pure, is primordial solitude itself, primordial unborn-ness itself, and primordial unarisen-ness itself."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, why is it called 'intrinsic nature'?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, it is unchanging — and for that reason it is called 'intrinsic nature.' It is luminous from the very beginning and is not afflicted — and for that reason it is called 'intrinsic nature.' It is equal through its very equality with space, and it is boundless — and for that reason it is called 'intrinsic nature.' It is free of conceptual elaboration, it is free of movement, and it is luminosity — and for that reason it is called 'intrinsic nature.' It has nothing to be taken up and nothing to be cast aside — and for that reason it is called 'intrinsic nature.'"

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, who are those who do not know intrinsic nature?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, those who do not know the intrinsic nature of phenomena."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, who are those who do know intrinsic nature?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, those who know the intrinsic nature of those very phenomena."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the defining mark of one who possesses faith?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, the defining mark of one who possesses faith is having perfectly transcended all attachment."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, how does a monk who does not possess faith have faith in what is given through faith?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, one who is said to 'not possess faith' is someone who, with respect to all phenomena that have become manifest, does not rely on others and does not go again and again on the basis of another's faith — and for that reason such a one is called one who 'does not possess faith.' Such a person does not make use of what is given through faith. Why is that? Because of being primordially pure."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, what should be said of a monk who does not dwell together with the Saṅgha?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, a monk who does not dwell together with the Saṅgha thereby becomes a field of offering for the world. Why is that? Divine youth, the Saṅgha is the unconditioned, and a bodhisattva does not dwell together with the unconditioned — and for that reason such a one becomes a field of offering for the world."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, if a bodhisattva were to dwell together with the unconditioned, what fault would arise?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, having attained the unconditioned, such a one would not protect sentient beings and would become a śrāvaka — that is the fault that would arise."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, the conditioned is the ground of the ordinary person, and the unconditioned is the ground of noble ones. If that is so, how does a bodhisattva, having abandoned the ground of the noble ones and dwelling on the ground of the ordinary person, become a field of offering for the world?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, a bodhisattva neither dwells in the conditioned nor dwells in the unconditioned — and for that reason such a one becomes a field of offering for the world. Why is that? Divine youth, a bodhisattva is one who has turned the mind away from formations and who does not abide in the unconditioned, and who is thus free of the faults of the conditioned and who has realized the knowledge of the unconditioned. Because of being free of the faults of the conditioned, such a one does not abide in the conditioned; and because of having realized the knowledge of the unconditioned, such a one does not fall into the unconditioned. Divine youth, consider this analogy: a great powerful archer shoots an arrow upward into the open sky above, and then that arrow, without remaining in the sky yet also without falling to the ground —"

Mañjuśrī asked: "Divine youth, is this somewhat difficult?"

The divine youth replied: "Mañjuśrī, it is difficult indeed."

Mañjuśrī said: "Divine youth, even more difficult than that are those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who neither abandon the conditioned nor fail to attain the unconditioned, who do not fall into the unconditioned, and who also bring to full maturation whatever conditioned attainments there are. That is most difficult of all."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, is the deterioration of a bodhisattva conditioned or unconditioned? From which of the two does it arise?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Divine youth, the deterioration of a bodhisattva can arise from the conditioned, and it can also arise from the unconditioned. Why is that? From the conditioned there arises deterioration accompanied by affliction, while from the unconditioned there arises deterioration free of affliction."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, what deterioration could there be that is free of affliction?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Divine youth, within the three realms there exists deterioration accompanied by affliction. But a bodhisattva who allows no affliction within the three realms — such a one would become a śrāvaka."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way does a bodhisattva have no deterioration?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Divine youth, when a bodhisattva engages with the conditioned through the knowledge of wisdom, and through the knowledge of skillful means does not fall into the unconditioned — in that case, divine youth, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva does not, out of regard for sentient beings, abandon the conditioned, and does not, out of regard for the qualities of a buddha, fall into the unconditioned — in that case, divine youth, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva, for the sake of gathering the accumulation of merit, applies himself to the conditioned, and for the sake of gathering the accumulation of a buddha's wisdom, does not fall into the unconditioned — in that case, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva, abiding in the unconditioned, cultivates the meditative concentrations, and abiding in skillful means, turns back from those meditative concentrations — in that case, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva, abiding in the awakening mind, gathers the roots of virtue, and abiding in great compassion, brings sentient beings to full maturation — in that case, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva, abiding in solitude, discerns the works of māra, and abiding in skillful means, abandons those works of māra — in that case, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva, abiding in great loving-kindness, teaches the Dharma, and abiding in great compassion, gives material gifts — in that case, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva, abiding in saṃsāra, performs the work of fully employing nirvāṇa, and abiding in nirvāṇa, performs the work of fully employing saṃsāra — by that very fact, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva takes birth through the absence of birth, manifests through the absence of transition, makes things appear through the view of phenomena, without being divided by aggregates, elements, and sense bases, and is harmonized with all things — peaceful and utterly at peace — yet blazes, and though blazing is not consumed by that blaze —"

purifying all afflictions while remaining unstained by the faults of those afflictions; taming those in training and those beyond training; not touching the liberation of the śrāvakas; entering into the aspirations of sentient beings without abandoning the aspiration toward the Dharma; recognizing the hooks of Māra without abandoning the hooks of Dharma; entering through wisdom and turning back through skillful means; displaying the appearance of a noble one while rejoicing in the task of ripening those who are not yet noble; delighting in the sight of a buddha while earnestly desiring the sight of the Dharma — by that very fact, the bodhisattva has no deterioration.

When Mañjuśrī, the divine youth, had given this teaching, fifty thousand divine youths obtained the pure and stainless eye of Dharma regarding all phenomena. Twenty-five thousand divine youths liberated their minds from all defilements through non-clinging, without remainder. Fifty thousand bodhisattvas who had previously cultivated wholesome roots attained the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena. Twenty thousand bodhisattvas gave rise to unobstructed eloquence. Among the beings of gods and humans, many hundreds of thousands of living creatures generated the awakening mind toward full awakening and made divine offerings to the Tathāgata and to Mañjuśrī, the divine youth. And further, the divine youth Rabrtsal (Exuberant Mind) said to Mañjuśrī, the divine youth, these words:

"Mañjuśrī, how does a bodhisattva abide on the path?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, when a bodhisattva teaches the Dharma for the purpose of abandoning attachment, yet does not actualize the absence of attachment; teaches the Dharma for the purpose of abandoning aversion, yet does not actualize the abandoning of aversion; teaches the Dharma for the purpose of abandoning delusion, yet does not actualize the abandoning of

delusion; teaches the Dharma for the purpose of abandoning the afflictions, yet does not actualize the abandoning of the afflictions — by that very fact, divine youth, the bodhisattva abides on the path.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva teaches sentient beings emptiness, yet does not actualize emptiness; teaches sentient beings the signless, yet does not actualize the signless; teaches sentient beings the wishless, yet does not actualize the wishless; and likewise teaches sentient beings the Dharma of non-volitional formation, non-arising, non-production, non-substantiality, the absence of attachment and its opposite, and cessation — yet does not actualize cessation — by that very fact, the bodhisattva abides on the path.

"Furthermore, divine youth, when a bodhisattva accomplishes the perfection of generosity through not utterly relinquishing; accomplishes the perfection of moral discipline through fully transcending it; accomplishes the perfection of patience through thoughts of harm; accomplishes the perfection of diligence through laziness; accomplishes the perfection of meditative concentration through forgetfulness; and accomplishes the perfection of wisdom through being dull and mute like a sheep — by that very fact, the bodhisattva abides on the path."

The divine youth then said:

Mañjuśrī then thought for a moment before speaking. Mañjuśrī said:

"Divine youth, the following four things are what bodhisattvas do not utterly relinquish. What are those four? Not utterly relinquishing sentient beings, not utterly relinquishing the Dharma, not utterly relinquishing the awakening mind, and not utterly relinquishing all virtuous phenomena. It is because a bodhisattva does not utterly relinquish these four things that he accomplishes the perfection of generosity.

"Divine youth, the phrase 'fully transcending moral discipline' is a term of praise signifying what is not its intrinsic nature. For it is by fully transcending moral discipline that one gains meditative absorption, by fully transcending meditative absorption that one gains wisdom, and by fully transcending wisdom that one accomplishes the knowledge of liberation. Therefore, divine youth, you should understand that by this synonym, one who fully transcends moral discipline thereby accomplishes the perfection of moral discipline.

"Divine youth, when a bodhisattva enters into thoughts of harm, he has turned away from the vehicle of the hearers and turned away from the vehicle of the solitary buddhas — and by that very fact he has entered well into the Great Vehicle. And one who has entered well into the Great Vehicle thereby accomplishes the perfection of patience.

"Divine youth, when a bodhisattva does not render his body coarse, does not render his speech coarse, and does not render his mind coarse — that is laziness. And one who in just that way strives ardently in the Dharma accomplishes the perfection of diligence.

"Divine youth, furthermore, a bodhisattva does not give rise to a mind of delight in the two lower grounds even in a dream — and that is forgetfulness. One who is forgetful with respect to the vehicles of the hearers and the solitary buddhas is thereby settled in meditative equipoise in the Great Vehicle, and so accomplishes the perfection of meditative concentration.

"Divine youth, all phenomena are inert — like grass, wood, a wall, a road, a scarecrow, and a sheep that is dull and mute — and are by their intrinsic nature without capacity. Therefore, when a bodhisattva, through wisdom and primordial gnosis, pursues awakening by seeing all phenomena as just that — as inert and like a sheep that is dull and mute — he thereby accomplishes the perfection of wisdom. A bodhisattva who has entered in this way accomplishes the path.

"Divine youth, furthermore, when a bodhisattva neither abandons the path of saṃsāra nor neglects to seek the path of nirvāṇa, does not cut the continuum of the path's activity, yet continues to accomplish the deeds of the path, and also establishes sentient beings who have entered a bad path onto the path — when that is so, the bodhisattva abides on the path.

"Divine youth, furthermore, when a bodhisattva seeks all sentient beings and all phenomena and finds none, yet does not abandon the path of awakening and meditates on the fruit as actually existing — when that is so, the bodhisattva has attained the path of awakening.

"Divine youth, furthermore, when a bodhisattva thoroughly knows the path of the hearers yet does not go forth by means of the hearers' path; thoroughly knows the path of the solitary buddhas yet does not go forth by means of the solitary buddhas' path; attains as well the path of the bodhisattvas, yet does not go forth by that path either while his faculties are not yet fully perfected — when that is so, the bodhisattva abides on the path.

"Divine youth, furthermore, when a bodhisattva fully accumulates all roots of virtue, and"

does not seek after the fruit of such accumulation, and is not tainted by the fault of accumulating, and dedicates all virtuous roots accumulated entirely to awakening, and rightly perceives no increase on account of awakening, and rightly perceives no decrease — when that is so, the bodhisattva abides on the path.

"Divine youth, furthermore, when a bodhisattva thoroughly seeks the path out of the bad path, yet having thoroughly sought the path does not make a definitive departure — when that is so, the bodhisattva abides on the path."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, how does a bodhisattva thoroughly seek the path out of the bad path?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, what is called the bad path is saṃsāra. The bodhisattva, abiding within it, thoroughly seeks the path for the sake of the definitive liberation of sentient beings, and not for the sake of his own definitive liberation."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, the conduct of a bodhisattva is entirely at odds with the whole world."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, it is just so. Bodhisattvas move about in the world, yet are not tainted by the phenomena of the world. They demonstrate the absence of afflictions, yet do not fall into the mere state of being without affliction. They demonstrate old age and death, yet know that all phenomena are unborn and unarisen. They do not actualise a faultless state, yet engage thoroughly with the aggregates, the elements, and the sense bases, while not seeking after the aggregates, the elements, and the sense bases. They teach the Dharma to sentient beings so that those beings may thoroughly know the aggregates, the elements, and the sense bases, yet do not cause them to arrive at that thorough knowledge for its own sake. They cultivate and fully accomplish the dhyānas, liberations, meditative absorptions, and meditative attainments, and they settle minds that are distracted, yet do not come to rest in that settledness. They present the domain of māra, yet are not seized by the works of māra. They do not abandon the domain of the buddhas, nor do they enter into the domain of māra. They do not turn away from the domain of the dharmadhātu, yet they take up the domain of the realm of sentient beings. For this reason, the conduct of those great sentient beings is entirely at odds

with the whole world."

The divine youth said: "Mañjuśrī, pray set forth the conduct of the bodhisattvas with boldness."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine youth, with intention utterly pure, they engage in elevated intention through inner and outer solitude. With the absence of coarse activity, they engage in earnest application. With non-forgetfulness of mind, they engage in not forgetting the awakening mind. With a tamed mind, they engage in generosity. With a pacified mind, they engage in moral discipline. With the absence of wounding, they engage in patience. With bodily and mental seclusion, they engage in diligence. With the dharmadhātu undistracted, they engage in meditative concentration. With the absence of conceptual elaboration, they engage in wisdom. With the absence of self toward sentient beings, they engage in loving-kindness. With utter pacification free from any actual affliction, they engage in compassion. Because of liberation by nature, they engage in joy. Because of freedom from the two extremes, they engage in equanimity. Because of having been unborn from the very beginning, they engage in the individual investigation of impermanence, and

because thorough investigation is itself suffering, they engage in the individual investigation of suffering. Because there is no such thing as a mistaken intrinsic nature, they engage in the individual investigation of selflessness. Because perception is thoroughly known, they engage in the individual investigation of peace. Because the aggregates are thoroughly known to be like illusions, they engage in the thorough knowledge of suffering. Because ignorance is what goes before, they engage in knowing the origin. Because cessation occurs by nature, they engage in knowing cessation. Because there is no attachment to conditioned things, they engage in knowing the path. Because the result is itself thoroughly known, they engage in knowing the cause. Because of dependent origination, they engage in knowing conditions. Because of multiplicity, they engage in assembly. Because it is beyond expression, they engage in the individual perfect discernment of meaning. Because the dharmadhātu is without division, they engage in the individual perfect discernment of phenomena. Because name and form do not arise, they engage in the individual perfect discernment of words and their definitions. Because it resembles an echo, they engage in the individual perfect discernment of confident eloquence. Because the syllables of words are clear in themselves, they engage in relying on meaning rather than letter. Because

the domain of consciousness has not been abandoned, they engage in relying on wisdom rather than ordinary knowing. Because the ripening of karma is emptiness, they engage in relying on sūtras of definitive meaning. Because persons are to be thoroughly ripened, they engage in relying on the Dharma rather than on persons. Because karma is thoroughly purified, they engage in the divine eye. Because ethical conduct is thoroughly purified, they engage in pure conduct. Because meditative absorption is thoroughly purified, they engage in knowing the minds of others. Because the three times are equal in nature, they engage in knowing the recollection of former abodes. Because they are masters over the mind, they engage in the accomplishment of miraculous powers. Because they are undivided, they engage in steadfast conduct. Because they are without slackening, they engage in firm conduct. Because they are without agitation, they engage in conduct without fixed abode. Because there is no distinction, they engage in conduct that is even and equal. Because nothing whatsoever is grasped at with examination, they conduct themselves like earth, water, fire, wind, and space. Because their defining mark is the accomplishment of all that appears, they engage with what is like an illusion. Because their defining mark is that of being untrue, they engage with what is like a dream. Because their defining mark is that of complete bewilderment, they engage with what is like a mirage. Because their defining mark is that the self is not to be found, they engage in emptiness. Because their defining mark is that mind has no intrinsic nature, they engage in the signless. Because their defining mark is that the three realms have no intrinsic nature, they engage in the wishless. Because their defining mark is that conditioned things have no intrinsic nature, they engage in non-fabrication. Because their defining mark is that mind, mentation, and consciousness do not enter in, they engage in the defeat of māra. Because their defining mark is the accomplishment of all conduct, they engage in never severing the lineage of the Three Jewels. O son of the gods, a bodhisattva who practices in this way is one who engages in the practice of a bodhisattva.

This is the third and final fascicle.

The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, this conduct of a bodhisattva truly transcends all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

Mañjuśrī said: O son of the gods, that is exactly so. O son of the gods, as for me, I am not a bodhisattva who is followed by faith, nor one who follows the Dharma, nor one who is a stream-enterer (the eighth), nor one who has entered the stream, nor a once-returner, nor a non-returner, nor an arhat, nor

a śrāvaka,

nor a pratyekabuddha, nor a blessed buddha, nor a Tathāgata, nor a perfectly and fully awakened buddha, nor a Teacher — one who is none of these is not what I would call a bodhisattva. O son of the gods, one who is not characterized by the nature of an ordinary being, not characterized by the nature of attachment, not characterized by the nature of aversion, not characterized by the nature of delusion, not characterized by the nature of cyclic existence, and not characterized by the nature of passing completely into nirvāṇa — such a one is not what I would call a bodhisattva.

The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, with what in mind do you say this? Mañjuśrī, how then is a bodhisattva one who follows by faith, one who follows the Dharma, the eighth, a stream-enterer, a once-returner, a non-returner, an arhat, a śrāvaka, a pratyekabuddha, a blessed buddha, a Tathāgata, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha, a Teacher, one with the nature of an ordinary being, one with the nature of attachment, one with the nature of aversion, one with the nature of delusion, one with the nature of cyclic existence, and one with the nature of passing completely into nirvāṇa?

Mañjuśrī said: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva has faith in all the qualities of buddhahood, and has faith in all attachments yet does not become attached to them, and does not go along on the basis of another's faith, and arouses and sustains faith in the path of the six perfections, and liberates those who have become bound by attachment, and earnestly seeks the gnosis free from attachment, and does not become attached to cyclic existence, and does not fall into nirvāṇa — by that alone, O son of the gods, a bodhisattva is one who follows by faith.

The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, how then is a bodhisattva one who follows the Dharma?

Mañjuśrī said: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva holds and retains everything taught by all buddhas, and is nourished by the food of Dharma while being without material food, and abides in the Dharma but does not abide in the afflictions, and possesses the power of the Dharma but not the power of pride, and speaks the Dharma but does not speak the idle talk of the world, and is a sovereign of the Dharma but not a sovereign of the afflictions, and relies on the Dharma but does not rely on persons, and speaks the Dharma but speaks nothing that is not the Dharma, and relies on teachings that accord with the Dharma but does not abide in teachings of abandoned

effort, and knows all phenomena as being without fault in their very nature, and is endowed with the gateways of dhāraṇī free from attachment, and is endowed with the seven noble riches, and fully upholds the sacred Dharma, and abides in the distinction of the Dharma — in that way, O son of the gods, a bodhisattva is one who follows the Dharma.

The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, how then is a bodhisattva the eighth?

Mañjuśrī said: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva has thoroughly transcended the eight wrong things and is well established in the eight right things, and is skilled in purifying the eightfold path, and does not use that path to achieve definitive emergence before the preparations are fully complete, and establishes sentient beings born in the eight states of non-leisure in conditions of perfect leisure and excellence, and abides in the eight kinds of discernment of the holy person, and meditates upon the eight liberations,

and who does not abandon the bodhisattva's superior intention — such a one, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva who is the eighth.

The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, how then is a bodhisattva a stream-enterer?

Mañjuśrī said: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva turns back from the stream those sentient beings who are inclined toward the stream, and cuts off every stream of saṃsāra yet does not actually sever saṃsāra itself, and cuts off the stream of all lower rebirths, and establishes sentient beings on the path that leads to a higher rebirth and to the direct realization of nirvāṇa, and severs the fetters, and inclines neither toward gods nor humans, and reveals what is true, and does not fall into conceit, and is free from doubt, and is resolute, and inclines toward the qualities of a buddha, and has fully crossed beyond the path of ordinary persons, and is firmly established on the path of the qualities of a buddha, and has fathomed the depths of saṃsāra, and has turned directly toward nirvāṇa, and has become a worthy recipient of the world's generosity, and has insight into conditioned phenomena and is fully discerned by the unconditioned, and is irreversible, and inclines genuinely toward the Saṅgha — such a one, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva who is a stream-enterer.

The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, how then is a bodhisattva a once-returner?

Mañjuśrī said: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva, having understood that all phenomena have neither coming nor going, returns deliberately out of the

intention to ripen sentient beings, and ripens sentient beings, and demonstrates coming and going, and sees that in the nature of reality there is neither coming nor going, and yet comes without affliction, and goes through the thorough purification of his own karma, and does not abandon the equanimity of coming, and does not go under the power of māra, and returns in order to point out the path of awakening, and returns in order to liberate the sentient beings he has embraced, and whose superior intention for awakening is firm and unbreakable — such a one, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva who is a once-returner.

The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, how then is a bodhisattva a non-returner?

Mañjuśrī said: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva does not return into views, into inversions, or into obscurations, and does not come and go through desire, attachment, aversion, fear, or delusion, and whose deeds are not yet finalized and who does not return before the qualities of a buddha are complete, and is skilled in the absence of coming and the absence of passing on, and has attained the state where there is neither aging nor death, and abides in the final stage, and whose deeds are finalized, and who has received a prophecy, and has attained the objectless and the aspectless, and whose knowing is not dependent on another — such a one, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva who is a non-returner.

The son of the gods said: Mañjuśrī, how then is a bodhisattva an arhat?

Mañjuśrī said: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva is without clinging and yet teaches the Dharma to sentient beings in order to tame attachment, and is without hatred and yet teaches the Dharma to sentient beings in order to tame aversion, and is without confusion and yet teaches the Dharma to sentient beings in order to tame delusion, and abides without affliction toward all phenomena, and does not abandon the mind toward any sentient being, and has set forth with diligence toward all the qualities of a buddha, and finds joy in the absence of delight in all desirable enjoyments, and, like an arhat and like a lotus, is unstained by all afflictions, and through wisdom is equal to the noble ones,

and yet, through skillful means, abides without being a noble one, and holds no sense of ownership over all that is appropriated and does not grasp at any of it, and yet claims ownership of all the qualities of a buddha and holds them fully, and is endowed with an undefiled mind in his own mental continuum, and causes others to abide in an undefiled way in their own mental continua, and

brings to complete fulfillment every aspiration that was formerly vowed, and has reached the far shore while those who dwell on the near and far shores remain there, and yet has not abandoned the station of the near shore, and liberates other sentient beings as others do — such, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva who is an arhat.

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva a śrāvaka?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva proclaims the Dharma of what has not been heard to all sentient beings and yet does not engage in sense objects, and proclaims the true and holy Dharma, the Dharma of non-arising and non-ceasing, and proclaims causes, conditions, selflessness, the absence of sentient beings, and the absence of movement through intrinsic nature, and proclaims the immeasurable qualities of a buddha and qualities equal to space, and proclaims that one should strive so that all phenomena become intimately familiar through the wisdom of buddhas and through great wisdom, and in proclaiming does not depend on others, and does not become conceited on account of learning, and fully comprehends that in all proclamation the beginning and end are not severed, and has attained the inexhaustible analytical knowledge, and the inexhaustible meaning, words, and syllables, and reveals to all sentient beings their minds, conduct, and understanding, and teaches the Dharma to each as is fitting, and abides in the ground of peace, and is free from conceptual elaboration, and acts from the conduct of former aspirations — such, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva who is a śrāvaka.

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva a pratyekabuddha?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva understands all phenomena as having the defining characteristic of dependence on conditions, of being without sentient beings, without a life-force, without a person, without an owner, and of arising through construction, and, because he clearly sees those conditions, cultivates the conditions that lead to awakening — namely, the aspects of all the perfections, the aspects of the qualities conducive to awakening, the aspects of the four means of gathering, the aspects of the four immeasurables, and perfectly accomplishes the aspects of the superknowledges — and, by cultivating those conditions in reliance on himself without depending on others, actualizes full and perfect awakening, and turns away in weariness from lower realms of existence, and is skilled in the Vinaya

through understanding of limited scope, and is well established in the Great Vehicle, and has made all phenomena manifest — such, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva who is a pratyekabuddha.

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva a buddha?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva realizes all phenomena as primordially solitary, and realizes all sentient beings as primordially selfless, and, for the sake of realizing names, understands all inferior, supreme, and intermediate modes of conduct, and through his own emptiness of affliction realizes all afflictions, and in a single instant displays the successive stages and their various conducts,

and who teaches the Dharma in accordance with the faculties and aspirations of sentient beings, and teaches the Dharma showing that it bears fruit — such, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva who is a buddha.

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva a Tathāgata?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva walks the path of the Tathāgata, does not forget suchness, abides perfectly in suchness, and possesses the generosity of suchness, the moral discipline of suchness, the patience of suchness, the diligence of suchness, the meditative concentration of suchness, the wisdom of suchness, the skillful means of suchness, the aspiration of suchness, the power of suchness, and the gnosis of suchness; and when there are no sentient beings in suchness, yet he fully liberates sentient beings; and when he dwells in the abode of sentient beings and moves within saṃsāra, yet has perfectly passed beyond all conduct, and liberates beings from conduct; and when he is both there and not there, both here and not here, and is purified of both; and when he is free from darkness, always luminous, without darkness, free from the shadow of darkness, follows suchness, and follows the ground of the Tathāgata — such, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva called a Tathāgata.

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva called a Blessed One (Bhagavān)?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva has subdued the afflictions, has crossed the river, has seen existence, bears the burden of all sentient beings, destroys existence, is free from the perception of existence, has conquered māra, has cast down the burden, transmigrates through death

and birth in the existences, knows what is to be done, has removed attachment to existence, cultivates body and mind, has cultivated moral discipline and wisdom, clearly sees the faults of existence, is free from craving for existence, has not abandoned his intention toward sentient beings, liberates beings from the ocean of existence, has well constructed a boat and a bridge, clearly sees through non-abiding, strives with the mind always in cultivation, brings to exhaustion the existence of sentient beings, has turned back completely from all existence, is skilled in skillful means, pulverizes all afflictions, is skilled in the sport of existence, and is venerated by those dwelling in the three existences — such, O son of the gods, is a bodhisattva called a Blessed One.

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva a perfectly and completely awakened buddha?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva attains perfect and complete awakening in equanimity — the awakening being equal to whatever is equal to the unwavering; and attains perfect and complete awakening in equanimity — the awakening being equal to whatever the various modes of view, the inversions, the obscurations, the resolutions, and the thorough arisings are equal to; and attains perfect and complete awakening in equanimity — the awakening being equal to whatever attachment, aversion, and delusion are equal to, and whatever all the afflictions are equal to; and attains perfect and complete awakening in equanimity — equal to the phenomena of ordinary persons, the phenomena of those in training, the phenomena of śrāvakas, the phenomena of pratyekabuddhas,

and attains perfect and complete awakening in equanimity — the awakening being equal to whatever the phenomena of bodhisattvas are equal to; does not disturb equanimity; regards the three gateways to liberation as equal in equanimity; relies on conditions because all phenomena are pure from the very beginning; and attains perfect and complete awakening in equanimity — equal to space itself — through the motivating force of conceptualization regarding what does not exist. Such, O son of the gods, is the bodhisattva who is a perfectly and completely awakened buddha.

The son of the gods asked: Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva a teacher?

Mañjuśrī replied: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva teaches, fully teaches, and thoroughly demonstrates whatever he demonstrates — all those to whom he teaches come to possess the quality of being unmoved; they come to hold

the teaching in its entirety; he becomes the sole teacher in the world system of the great trichiliocosm, teaching and fully teaching; he becomes a refuge, an island, and a support for all sentient beings; all signs are pacified, utterly pacified, and thoroughly appeased in him; he is free from doubt and is skilled in cutting through the doubt of all sentient beings; he is paid homage by Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), by Brahmā, and by the world-protectors; he speaks truthfully and is paid homage by the three realms; his mind, vast as space, is without inflation; because he sees the ultimate limit clearly and well, he is not humbled by any form of scorn, beating, ridicule, slander, anger, contempt, or menace, nor is he cowed by any kind of conceit; and because he sees clearly the intrinsic nature of sentient beings, he is beneficial and loving toward all sentient beings, and becomes renowned throughout the world as a teacher. Such, O son of the gods, is the bodhisattva who is a teacher.

The son of the gods asked: Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva one who possesses the qualities of an ordinary person?

Mañjuśrī replied: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva demonstrates, through skillful means, all the conduct of ordinary persons, and yet through wisdom does not become attached to any of the conduct of ordinary persons — such, O son of the gods, is the bodhisattva who possesses the qualities of an ordinary person.

The son of the gods asked: Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva one who possesses the quality of attachment?

Mañjuśrī replied: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva always comes to be devoted to the qualities of the buddhas, always comes to be thoroughly devoted to the form bodies of the buddhas, always comes to be devoted to dwelling in solitude in order to accomplish meditative concentration, meditative absorption, and the attainment of samādhi, always comes to be devoted to gathering sentient beings together through the four means of gathering, and comes to have no mind of enmity toward any sentient being — such, O son of the gods, is the bodhisattva who possesses the quality of attachment.

The son of the gods asked: Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva one who possesses the quality of aversion?

Mañjuśrī replied: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva comes to view conditioned phenomena as thoroughly and singularly faulty and flawed; comes to feel aversion toward the vehicles of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas;

perceives all afflictions and all formations as defects, yet does not actually abandon the afflictions and the formations; does not interrupt the stream of diligence for the sake of bringing sentient beings to full maturation; and with a mind thoroughly held by great compassion, genuinely gives rise to vast loving-kindness —

— and for the sake of bringing sentient beings to full maturation, draws them out from the swamp and mire of affliction; and toward sentient beings who are filled with aversion, cultivates and establishes patience, while pointing out the faults of the afflictions themselves; and employs every means against death and transmigration, and reveals the wretchedness of saṃsāra — then, O son of the gods, that bodhisattva is one who possesses the quality of aversion.

The son of the gods asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who possesses the quality of delusion?

Mañjuśrī replied: O son of the gods, delusion is that which does not know anything whatsoever. Therefore, when a bodhisattva enters into meditative equipoise upon the essential nature of phenomena, and in that equipoise does not know, does not discriminate, does not perceive throughout, does not grasp, does not abandon, does not arise, does not cease, does not waver, does not conceive with pride, does not stir — and enters into meditative equipoise upon cessation as the intrinsic nature of phenomena — then, O son of the gods, that bodhisattva is one who possesses the quality of delusion.

The son of the gods asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who possesses the quality of saṃsāra?

Mañjuśrī replied: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva neither departs from saṃsāra yet from within it continues to seek out the qualities of the buddhas; shares nothing in common with all the māras, and is unmixed with those of inferior conduct; separates sentient beings from inferior conduct and establishes them in the vast conduct; brings their aims into accord with the Dharma; proclaims the faultiness of all non-virtue, turns their inclinations back from it, and causes them to turn away; makes them understand that awakening is to be inclined toward rather than saṃsāra; regards the equality of saṃsāra as the equality of the buddhas; yet neither departs from saṃsāra nor abides fixedly within it — then, O son of the gods, that bodhisattva is one who possesses the quality of saṃsāra.

The son of the gods asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who possesses the quality of complete nirvāṇa?

Mañjuśrī replied: O son of the gods, when a bodhisattva views all sentient beings as completely passed into nirvāṇa by their intrinsic nature; comes to know all phenomena as pacified by their intrinsic nature; teaches the Dharma for the sake of bringing all sentient beings to complete nirvāṇa and to utter pacification; pacifies and leads to complete nirvāṇa the immeasurable sentient beings blazing with the three fires; abides in and practices nirvāṇa; yet, though the passage into complete nirvāṇa is the final passage into complete nirvāṇa, does not pass into complete nirvāṇa — then, O son of the gods, that bodhisattva is one who possesses the quality of complete nirvāṇa, skilled in skillful means, resolved in the understanding of skillful means, benefiting all sentient beings, and endowed with loving compassion for them.

When Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful bodhisattva, had taught this teaching, more than one hundred thousand living beings gained the dust-free and stainless pure Dharma-eye regarding all phenomena. Sixty thousand living beings had their minds liberated from all defilements without remainder. Those sentient beings who had previously planted roots of virtue and had served and venerated many buddhas attained patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti). Twenty-five thousand bodhisattvas each individually attained the dhāraṇī called the Treasury of Inexhaustible Aspects. Two hundred and fifty thousand living beings gave rise to the mind of unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening. And from the sky above, the Blessed One and —

— showers of flowers rained down from the sky in offering to Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful.

Then the god's son Rātsal Sem addressed Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, with these words: "Mañjuśrī, how is it that a bodhisattva is definitively liberated through skillful means and wisdom?"

Thereupon Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, replied to the god's son Rātsal Sem in verse:

When mind is free from attachment,
that is the unsurpassed awakening mind.
The direct perception of the nature of mind —
that is the defining mark of wisdom.

Dedicating entirely to awakening
all the minds that are aroused,

and excelling above the awakening mind —
that is the defining mark of skillful means.

Knowing all sentient beings as selfless,
as untrue, as hollow to the very marrow —
the knowing by which one comes to know this —
that is the defining mark of wisdom.

Because one gives everything to all sentient beings
for the sake of awakening,
and gathers them with sincere intention —
that is the defining mark of skillful means.

When one never beholds self and awakening
as permanent and fixed,
and the three spheres are utterly purified —
that is the defining mark of wisdom.

Relinquishing everything, inner and outer,
and dedicating it to all sentient beings —
that is the defining mark of skillful means.

Peaceful, supremely tranquil, pure and clean,
yet harboring no pride in one's moral discipline,
with body, speech, and mind at peace —
that is the defining mark of wisdom.

Entering into moral discipline oneself,
bringing others also into moral discipline,
and dedicating that discipline to buddhahood —
for that reason it is called skillful means.

Training in patience with the understanding
that all phenomena are utterly empty and selfless,
yet unimpaired in body and mind —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

Not engaging through the body,
nor through speech or mind,
remaining in solitude with respect to all phenomena —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

Enduring the rage, the killing, and the binding
of all sentient beings,
and not abandoning those beings —
that is the Perfection of Skillful Means.

For the sake of bringing sentient beings to full ripening,
relinquishing the bliss of meditative concentration
and making oneself present in towns and villages —
that is the Perfection of Skillful Means.

Not on this side, not on the far side,
abiding supremely on the side that accords,
with the stream of conceptually elaborated views cut through —
that is the realization of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Having realized emptiness,
one does not fall into equanimity,
but brings sentient beings into emptiness —
that is the manner of skillful means.

Viewing the Buddha, who is formless like space,
through the gateway of Dharma,
and at that time being unattached to form —
that is the defining mark of wisdom.

Desiring to venerate the defining marks of the buddhas,
making offerings to ten million buddhas,
and bringing all guides into offering practice —
for that reason it is called skillful means.

All phenomena are stainless and free from stain,
equal in being equal to space,
and one does not grasp at any phenomenon at all —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

For the sake of fully upholding the Dharma,
casting aside body and life,
and remaining remote from the whole world —
that is the gateway of skillful means.

Because of abiding in the dharmadhātu itself,
dwelling supremely at the genuine limit,
and being unmoved from suchness —

that is the gateway of wisdom.

Whatever the nature of phenomena may be like,
knowing sentient beings to be just like that,
and the final extent of contemplating them thus —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

Knowing that no phenomenon ever undergoes death and transference,
and knowing it as without birth,
yet not falling into non-movement or rushing about —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

For the sake of bringing sentient beings to full ripening,
the wise one takes birth intentionally
in the desire realm and in the form realm —
those are the qualities of skillful means.

Dwelling in solitude and abiding in the utmost solitude,
abiding in what is free from affliction,
and making meditative concentration and liberation one's support —
these are the defining marks of wisdom.

Going to towns and villages
and teaching with pleasing words,
inexhaustible and without timidity —
that is the wise one skilled in skillful means.

Fearing all three worlds
yet not resorting to crowds and bustle,
with oneself tamed and become peaceful —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

However many great assemblies,
gatherings, and crowds of beings there may be,
appearing among them all
yet not speaking through skillful means — that is what is meant.

Practicing with stability and without attachment,
not pursuing the letter,
and seeking the inexpressible, definitive meaning —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

The wise one appearing in every place of attachment,
teaching the phenomena of the Dharma,
and proclaiming praise of the Three Jewels —
that is the Perfection of Skillful Means.

Skilled in and knowing the higher knowledges,
peaceful, tamed, and free from defilements,
with no conceit and no fixed position —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

Displaying transformations through the higher knowledges,
traveling to countless realms,
and making offerings to tens of millions of buddhas —
those are the defining marks of skillful means.

Knowing the aggregates to be like illusions
and knowing afflictions to be without real existence,
thereby pacifying all māras —
that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

Presenting all the māras,
defeating them by exposing them,
and thereby liberating sentient beings from them —
that is the gateway of skillful means.

Teaching the gateways of liberation —
emptiness, signlessness,
and the absence of wishful striving —
those are the defining marks of wisdom.

Without attachment, without aversion,
dwelling in the domain of knowledge that is without delusion,
with nothing to be taken up or cast aside —
those are the defining marks of wisdom.

Endowed with the supreme of all aspects,
relying thoroughly on emptiness,
and having crossed to the far shore for all —
those are the defining marks of equanimity and cessation.

Those who are undefiled and yet not rigidly restrained —
these become endowed with wisdom,
and their domain within cyclic existence

becomes a companion for all sentient beings.

The wise one who is skilled in skillful means
is never satisfied with accumulating merit.

The path that possesses both these limbs —
wisdom and skillful means —
is that of the learned bodhisattva,
and through it the guides are certain to arise.

Without skillful means, wisdom alone
cannot bring about what has not yet come to be.
Without wisdom, skillful means alone
cannot lead the skilled one to perfect peace.

When wisdom and knowledge of skillful means
are mingled together throughout,
and both are practiced in union,
one thereby realizes what is supreme.

Those who travel this path going forward
are extolled by all the buddhas,
and they arrive at the perfection of primordial wisdom —
for that is the nature of reality of all phenomena.

They delight in the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena,
which is inseparable from the domain of the buddhas,
and they realize the unsurpassed awakening of the buddhas —
stainless awakening.

Then the son of the gods Prabhalamanas also spoke these words to Mañjuśrī,
the ever-youthful:

"Mañjuśrī, what is the domain of awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the domain of awakening is precisely the
solitude of one's own domain."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the defining mark of awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, awakening has the defining mark of space."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the ultimate extent of awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the ultimate extent of awakening is emptiness."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the location of awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the location of awakening is the location of all phenomena."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the gateway of awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the gateway of awakening is a gateway that is everywhere."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the entering upon awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Son of the gods, the entering upon awakening is the selflessness of all sentient beings."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, with what is awakening equal?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, awakening is equal to the non-arising of all phenomena."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the traversing of awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the traversing of awakening is the minds and conduct of all sentient beings. The traversing of awakening is going without going, and journeying without journeying."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is awakening consonant with?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, awakening is consonant with great compassion."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is great compassion consonant with?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, great compassion is consonant with liberating all sentient beings completely."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, where is awakening to be sought?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, awakening is to be sought through the thorough understanding of the afflictions of all sentient beings."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, where are the afflictions to be sought?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the afflictions are to be sought in the noble eightfold path."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, does the noble path then dwell together with the afflictions?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, if the noble path were something that had become twofold, then the noble path might indeed dwell together with the afflictions. But, son of the gods, the noble path has not become twofold. The very act of seeking the afflictions is itself the noble path."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way has the path performed the function of a path?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, when one seeks and finds no afflictions, finds no saṃsāra, and finds no nirvāṇa — in that way the path has performed the function of a path."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the path of a bodhisattva?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the path of a bodhisattva is the sixty-two kinds of wrong views, the four inversions, the five obscurations, and all phenomena belonging to the side of non-virtue."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, with what in mind do you say this?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, because a bodhisattva is engaged with sentient beings, awakening is not to be sought anywhere other than in the very wrong views, inversions, obscurations, and non-virtuous phenomena of those sentient beings. Why is that? It is because a bodhisattva seeks out the very wrong views, inversions, obscurations, and afflictions by which sentient beings are thoroughly differentiated. And in that seeking, one finds no sentient being, and one finds no afflictions. Since one finds nothing, one does not grow weary of bringing sentient beings to complete maturation. Therefore, son of the gods, by this account, the seeking of afflictions is the path of a bodhisattva, and the seeking of sentient beings is also the path of a bodhisattva, and the seeking of aggregates, elements, sense bases, and afflictions is also the path of a bodhisattva."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, are not the three gateways of liberation the path of a bodhisattva?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, emptiness cannot be sought, and signlessness and wishlessness likewise cannot be sought. Why is that? Son of

the gods, in those, mind, mentation, and consciousness do not engage — and what mind, mentation, and consciousness do not engage with cannot be sought."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, how is the path to be directly realized?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Son of the gods, whatever right view is equal to, wrong view is equal to that as well — and the direct realization of this equality is the direct realization of the path. Whatever right intention is equal to, wrong intention is equal to that as well; whatever right speech is equal to, wrong speech is equal to that as well; whatever right action in its full extent is equal to, wrong action in its full extent is equal to that as well; whatever right livelihood is equal to, wrong livelihood is equal to that as well; whatever right effort is equal to, wrong effort is equal to that as well; whatever right mindfulness is equal to, wrong mindfulness is equal to that as well; whatever right meditative absorption is equal to, wrong meditative absorption is equal to that as well — and the direct realization of this equality is the direct realization of the path."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what is right view equal to?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, right view and wrong view are equal to emptiness and to solitude itself."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, what distinction is there between emptiness and solitude?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, what distinction is there between space and space?"

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, there is not the slightest distinction."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, in the same way, between emptiness and solitude there is not the slightest distinction either."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, from what is distinction derived?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, distinction is derived from characteristics, from referential objects, from perception, and from conceptual elaboration. But whoever follows through in understanding the essential nature of characteristics, referential objects, perception, and conceptual elaboration — for such a one there is no distinction. Son of the gods, consider this example: waters that have not entered the great ocean can be distinguished from one another, but waters that have entered the great ocean cannot be

distinguished. In the same way, son of the gods, for one who has not thoroughly understood the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, all phenomena appear distinct from one another; but for one who has thoroughly understood the dharmadhātu, phenomena are no longer distinct."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, is it possible to thoroughly understand the dharmadhātu?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the dharmadhātu cannot be thoroughly understood. Why is that? Son of the gods, all phenomena are authentically gathered into the dharmadhātu, and the dharmadhātu cannot thoroughly understand the dharmadhātu. Those phenomena that are authentically gathered into the dharmadhātu — knowing them as non-dual: that is called thorough understanding, because it brings to rest the passage of mind from one to another. That is called thorough understanding because it abides in the awareness of others. Son of the gods, consider this example: just as all forms appear within the luminous expanse of space, which is itself formless, and yet those forms are of the very nature of space — in the same way, son of the gods, although the bodhisattva sees all phenomena through the gateway of the dharmadhātu of which he himself has spoken, those phenomena are nothing other than the very nature of the dharmadhātu."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, how does a bodhisattva understand through the summit of the head?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, understanding through the summit of the head means teaching the Dharma from one's own view in order to abandon the views of all sentient beings."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, how does a bodhisattva understand through elaboration?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Son of the gods, because of seclusion, I do not make self into something other, nor do I make no-self into something other."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who does not lead?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, it is when a bodhisattva does not lead any phenomenon whatsoever."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who takes up a dwelling?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, it is when a bodhisattva does not stir from the dwelling that is free of signs."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, is there a category by which a bodhisattva appears to those three assemblies — those who are definitively set, those who are indefinitely set, and those who are set on the wrong course?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, there is."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, how is it?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the bodhisattva is definitively set with respect to all the qualities of buddhahood. He is indefinitely set with respect to those of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. And he is set on the wrong course with respect to the task of liberating sentient beings from that."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, is there a category by which a bodhisattva obtains the inopportune and fails to obtain the opportune?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, there is."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, then why does a bodhisattva arouse great compassion toward those who have obtained the inopportune, and yet set aside those who have obtained the opportune — even them — for the sake of bringing sentient beings to full maturation?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, those assemblies of the fully liberated have obtained the opportune, and therefore the bodhisattva does not appear to them as a bodhisattva."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, have you obtained the inopportune, or have you obtained the opportune?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, I have neither obtained the opportune nor obtained the inopportune."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, why is that?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, because I have neither obtained nor perfectly obtained, am neither in the opportune nor in the inopportune, and do not form attachment to the opportune or the inopportune."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, by this category of Dharma, all the maṇḍalas of Māra are utterly severed."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, it is so because in this category of Dharma there is no thorough understanding of the aggregates, no removal of afflictions, and no true transcendence of Māra."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, by this application it has defeated the other non-Buddhists (tīrthikas)."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, it is so because in this there is no conduct of any tīrthika whatsoever."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, the victory banner of the Dharma has been raised."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, it is so because there is neither light nor darkness."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, by this the wheel of Dharma has been supremely turned."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, it is so because all extreme views have been utterly severed."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, this teaching of the Dharma has made how great a light of Dharma?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, those for whom there is neither light nor darkness — for them the light of Dharma has been made."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, those sentient beings who, upon hearing this category of Dharma, will develop faith — they are rare indeed."

Mañjuśrī replied —

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, who will develop faith in this?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, those who are not disturbed and unsettled by bondage."

The son of the gods said: "Mañjuśrī, who are those who are not disturbed and unsettled by bondage?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, those who do not seek liberation through the removal of attachment, aversion, delusion, and afflictions, and who —"

those who are liberated through the equipoise of equanimity with respect to attachment, aversion, delusion, and afflictions — for, since they do not apprehend bondage as such, they will not be disturbed and unsettled.

While Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, was teaching this exposition, approximately five hundred thousand sentient beings aroused the mind of awakening and spoke these words: "May we too, just as Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, and the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha have found these Dharmas, likewise come to attain them." From among the beings of gods and humans, more than one hundred thousand sentient beings gained the dust-free, stainless, and utterly purified Dharma-eye with regard to all phenomena. Sixty thousand sons of gods of the Pure Abode class were liberated in mind from the defilements without remainder. Eighty thousand sons of gods dwelling in the desire realm were likewise liberated in mind from the defilements without remainder. Twenty thousand sentient beings, monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen were likewise liberated in mind from the defilements without remainder. Seventy-two thousand bodhisattvas who had previously cultivated roots of virtue attained the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti). The entire assembled retinue gave rise to joy, gladness, elation, delight, happiness, and bliss, and proclaimed this acclamation:

How wonderful! The Dharma of non-referential, all-encompassing liberation has been excellently expounded.

By Mañjuśrī, the Youthful,
it has been taught in a supremely excellent way.

Then those bodhisattvas, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, and non-humans performed offerings worthy of gods and humans. From the sky above they rained down showers of divine flowers, showers of precious jewels, showers of garments, showers of incense, showers of perfumed water, and showers of powdered fragrance. The gods in the sky above caused hundreds of thousands of celestial instruments to resound. The laymen, laywomen, and King Prasenajit each made offerings to the Blessed One and to Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, with whatever wealth they possessed. The entire assembled retinue joined their palms together and spoke these words:

"Blessed One, for those who do not have faith in this category of Dharma, there is no arising of a buddha. For those who would abandon this category of Dharma, there is no going forth into renunciation. For those who, having accomplished this category of Dharma, do not abide in it, there is no full ordination. For them there is likewise no full ordination through the noble full ordination. For those who do not traverse this category of Dharma, there is no

conduct of a śramaṇa, and there is no conduct of a brahmin. For those who would be frightened by this category of Dharma, there is no attainment and no direct realization. For those who listen to this category of Dharma, who upon hearing it develop faith in it, who accept it, who master it thoroughly, who hold it, who recite it, who write it down, who seek a vessel for it, and who teach it to others —"

who embrace it with a mind free from weariness, who demonstrate it to others, who strive in it with diligence, who cause others also to strive in it with diligence, and who do not allow it to decline — these are noble sentient beings, great sentient beings, who have guarded the roots of virtue, who have served many buddhas, who have found depth, who have cut the stream of wrong downfalls, who have closed the doors to the lower realms and to evil destinies, who are thoroughly embraced by spiritual friends, who are deeply respectful toward spiritual friends, and who feel and are aware of what their spiritual friends have done for them. These beings have entered upon the path of being thoroughly held in the sacred Dharma by the Blessed Buddhas of the past, the future, and the present. For those noble persons there is the arising of a buddha. For them there is the turning of the wheel of Dharma. For them there is fruit, and they are endowed with occasion."

Then the Blessed One expressed his approval to those assembled in that entire gathering, and spoke to the bodhisattva Maitreya (the bodhisattva of loving-kindness): "Maitreya, when this category of Dharma was being taught, from among the multitude of gods and humans twenty-two thousand beings attained the Dharma eye — pure, free from dust and stainless — with regard to phenomena. From among the multitude of gods and humans, eight hundred thousand beings were liberated in mind from the defilements without remainder. Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-soaring eagles), kinnaras (half-humans), and mahoragas (great serpents), together with monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen — twenty million of them aroused the mind of awakening. Five hundred thousand bodhisattvas — both those dwelling here and those gathered from other world-systems — attained the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti). Approximately two thousand bodhisattvas of varied aspirations each separately attained various dhāraṇīs. One hundred thousand bodhisattvas each separately attained the stainless dhāraṇī. Among them, many bodhisattvas will thoroughly uphold the sacred Dharma when you, bodhisattva Maitreya, attain awakening, and will receive, teach, and hold

sūtras of such profound depth, and will also read them. You yourself, Maitreya, will prophesy their awakening."

Then the bodhisattva Maitreya addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, those sons or daughters of noble family who hold this sūtra, read it, teach it, write it down, and make it into a volume in order that the sacred Dharma may long endure, and who even cause it to be heard a few times or cause it to resound through the ear — how much merit will they generate?"

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Maitreya thus: "Maitreya, it is excellent, excellent that you intend to ask the Tathāgata about this matter. Therefore, Maitreya, listen well, hold it in mind, and I shall explain it to you.

"Maitreya, consider this firmly by way of example: if some god or human from among the multitude of gods and humans were to serve the Blessed Buddhas — together with their retinues as numerous as the grains of sand of the river Gaṅgā — for a number of aeons equal to the grains of sand of the river Gaṅgā, providing them with all comforts and necessities — even beyond that is the merit of one who writes down this well-spoken sūtra, holds it, reads it, practices in accordance with suchness,

teaches it to others — that person generates far more merit still, and will swiftly draw near to the heart of awakening, not long delayed before attaining the complete and perfect awakening (bodhi).

Maitreya, I hereby prophesy that those who, having heard this sūtra, do not reject it but hold it in faith — and even those who merely copy it in a book — all of these, in accordance with their faith, are prophesied to be irreversible.

Maitreya, if I prophesy that even those who merely hear the name of a profound sūtra such as this will bear fruit, what need is there to speak of those who hold it in faith, write it in letters, read it, and teach it to others? Those who write down this sūtra, receive its scriptural transmission, recite it, read it, and practice in accordance with suchness — these will hold discourse together with the Blessed Buddhas and will be said to have drawn near to them. They will be forever inseparable from the Blessed Buddhas. And the Blessed Buddhas dwelling in other world-realms, together with the great bodhisattvas, will teach them and prophesy their attainment of unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, hearing this enumeration of the Dharma is like the arising of a buddha. Ānanda, you should therefore hold this enumeration of the Dharma and teach it widely to others."

Ānanda asked: "Blessed One, what is the name of this enumeration of the Dharma? How should it be held? And by what name should it be proclaimed?"

The Blessed One replied: "Ānanda, hold this enumeration of the Dharma by the name 'The Questions of the Young God Supraṭiṣṭhitamati,' and also by the name 'The Teaching of Mañjuśrī — The Teaching That Thoroughly Establishes All Phenomena.' "

Then, upon hearing the name of this enumeration of the Dharma, all those in the retinue joined their palms together and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, we have heard many teachings presented by the youthful Mañjuśrī, yet a Dharma taught as thoroughly and as extensively as this enumeration of the Dharma has never arisen before. Nor have we ever before experienced such joy in an enumeration of the Dharma as we feel now. Therefore, Blessed One, even after you have passed completely into nirvāṇa, may this enumeration of the Dharma continue to perform the deeds of a buddha for the benefit of the many, so that beings of future times may encounter it, and so that sentient beings of varying aspirations, having heard this enumeration of the Dharma, may, in accordance with their respective aspirations, emerge toward liberation by way of the various vehicles, and that they may proceed to the happy realms. We therefore request, Blessed One, that you bestow your blessing upon this enumeration of the Dharma."

Then the Blessed One, understanding the request that had been made by those four members of the retinue, gazed out in all ten directions. The moment the Blessed One gazed in all ten directions, the great earth of this trichiliocosm — the great thousandfold world-system — trembled and quaked in six ways. And the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (gandharva), asuras, garuḍas (garuḍa), kinnaras (kinnara), and great serpents were all filled with delight, satisfaction, exultation, enthusiasm, joy, and

happiness arose within them, and in order that this enumeration of the Dharma might not decline in future times, they offered divine worship to the Tathāgatas, to the bodhisattvas who delight in sentient beings, and to the śrāvaka Saṅgha. From the sky above, showers of flowers rained down. Divine cymbals resounded, and songs of celestial melody were taken up and played.

The line "are without inherent blessing" renders a clause meaning the phenomena lack any autonomous or self-empowering force beyond conditioned arising; the term translated "blessing" here is the ordinary sense of *byin gyis rlob pa* as an inherent animating power, which is denied of conditioned phenomena — distinct from the devotional sense of *adhiṣṭhāna* elsewhere.

- The final verse breaks off mid-sentence, as the source passage itself is incomplete, ending abruptly. The rendering faithfully reflects this open ending.

The phrase rendered "echo" (*brag ca*) literally means "cliff-echo" or "cave-echo" — a common simile in Buddhist literature for the way sounds and words, though appearing meaningful, are empty of inherent content, just as an echo merely reflects without possessing meaning of its own.

The line "move through the world like the moon" renders a somewhat compressed image: the bodhisattva, like the moon traversing the sky, illumines all beings without obstruction.

- The phrase rendered "not abandoning it — in harmony, there is no self whatsoever" reflects a compressed verse line: the sense is that one who perseveres with diligent, concordant practice, without ever abandoning it, realizes that there is no self of any kind anywhere. The exact syntactic division of this line admits two readings; the one chosen best fits the doctrinal context.

The term rendered "five superknowledges" (*abhijñā*) refers to the standard set of five: supernormal powers of physical transformation, divine ear, knowledge of others' minds, recollection of past lives, and divine eye. The text will likely enumerate these or assume them as known; they are glossed here for the listener's orientation.

- The phrase rendered "difficult to approach" for བསམ་པར་མཁྱེན་པ་ལ་མཁྱེན་པ་ is worth noting: the term can also suggest "hard to associate with" or "unapproachable" in the sense of transcending ordinary intimacy. The rendering chosen reflects the doctrinal point that such bodhisattvas are purposeful in all relationships yet remain beyond ordinary comprehension.

The line མཁྱེན་པ་ལ་མཁྱེན་པ་ལ་མཁྱེན་པ་ལ་མཁྱེན་པ་ལ་མཁྱེན་པ་ is idiomatically compressed. The image མཁྱེན་པ་ ("like a granary") combined with མཁྱེན་པ་ ("emptied out, with nothing remaining") suggests aggregates recognized as hollow like a storehouse stripped bare — rendered here as "like a granary empty of grain" to capture the image for a listening audience.

The verse section at the close is incomplete in the source passage as given; the translation renders what is present and stops where the Tibetan stops.

- The phrase rendered "they do not on that account display conceited refutation" translates a difficult line where the bodhisattva, knowing afflictions arise from conceptual proliferation, refrains from teaching this in a manner tinged with arrogance. The Tibetan "sñrel źir" (སྒྲེལ་ཞིར་) is literally "in a gentle, utterly subduing manner" or possibly "with quiet annihilation," and the compound "sñrel źir bsgrub pa" in the prose means to refute with a calm, decisive thoroughness that cuts down the conceited without aggression. The verse rendering attempts to convey both the refusal to act with pride and the implication of the prose section. Some ambiguity in the precise connotation remains.

The final verse line is left in its syntactically open form because it runs continuously into the next passage, as indicated by the structure of the original.

- The phrase rendered "reach the far shore" translates a Tibetan verb meaning to have crossed over to the other side, a standard *pāramitā* idiom, applied here to both moral discipline and the four analytical knowledges. The four analytical knowledges refer to the *pratisaṃvids*: analytical knowledge of phenomena, meaning, language, and eloquence, standard in Mahāyāna lists. The phrase "beings will portray them" renders a verb meaning to draw or depict, in the sense of

drawing images in homage, a conventional expression of veneration.

- The phrase rendered "like the moon in the fifteenth night" refers to the full moon of the fifteenth day of the lunar month, a standard Indic image for perfection and brilliance. The comparison emphasizes that such a bodhisattva shines most resplendently amid all the virtues as the full moon shines among the stars.

The "four māras" is a standard doctrinal list comprising the māra of the aggregates, the māra of afflictions, the māra of death, and the divine māra, though the text here does not enumerate them individually.

The final two lines of the translation represent the opening of a verse that continues beyond the passage given; the translation has rendered exactly what is present in the Tibetan provided.

- The exclamation rendered "Wondrous is the Dharma!" translates the interjection "a la la chos," a formulaic expression of joyful wonder at the Dharma. The rendering captures its liturgical force without literal awkwardness.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the Tibetan as given; Mañjuśrī's reply to the final question is cut off.

- The phrase rendered "analyze all phenomena and find nothing" translates a construction meaning something like "when they analyze all phenomena, they find nothing to be obtained" — pointing to the Madhyamaka theme that analysis of phenomena yields no findable, inherently existent referent. This is the doctrinal basis for fearlessness in assemblies.

The paradox of "teaching the Dharma to sentient beings" being defined as "turning away from all speech" reflects the standard Great Vehicle teaching that the deepest Dharma instruction is the recognition of the unborn, inexpressible nature of reality — silence or non-conceptual communication as the highest teaching.

- The phrase rendered "the six faculties" refers to the standard Buddhist enumeration of six sense faculties, eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind. The passage appears to say that bodhisattvas use the full range of these faculties to assess the faculties of others, a common pedagogical theme. The exact doctrinal import of "regard all the faculties through the six faculties" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan, but this rendering follows the most natural reading.

The phrase translated as "the gradual practice of composure" renders the Tibetan term for a graduated or step-by-step cultivation of stillness or meditative ease, here deployed as an antidote to the subtle pride of those who grasp at nirvāṇa as superior to saṃsāra or vice versa.

- The phrase rendered "refuge and support" translates རྒྱུ་རྒྱུ་ལྷན་པོ་, which more literally means "one who sustains" or "a provider of livelihood." The rendering "refuge and support" captures the sense of a sustaining presence for all sentient beings, which fits the doctrinal context. The final sentence is incomplete in the source passage and the translation breaks off at the same point accordingly.

- The god's son addressed in the second section is named Prabalacetā in Tibetan as རྒྱལ་ལེ་ཙཱ་མེ་, which may correspond to a Sanskrit name such as Prabalacetā or Balavīryamati; the exact Sanskrit is not established with certainty here.

The phrase rendered "shelter of the Dharma" translates རྒྱུ་རྒྱུ་ལྷན་པོ་, literally a "covering" or "canopy" of the Dharma. The Sanskrit equivalent would likely be dharmacchādāna or similar; this is a somewhat unusual technical expression, and the metaphor of shelter or canopy is retained for doctrinal fidelity.

- The phrase rendered "without equal and without non-equal" reflects the Tibetan's inversion of the preceding passage's closing line ("without an equal, because it is equal to space"): here the

Dharma transcends both categories, having no antidote that could be set against it. The logic is that an antidote implies a measured equivalence or opposition; this Dharma surpasses both.

The line "a mind that recollects the gods by relying on rebirth" likely refers to the practice of recollecting divine beings as objects of devotion with the aim of obtaining a divine rebirth, which the text treats as a form of mental turbidity because it is motivated by attachment to conditioned existence.

- The term rendered throughout as "striving with exertion" (Tibetan: lhag par byed pa) is a deliberately paradoxical expression in this context. Literally it means something like "doing additionally" or "doing with effort or superiority," but the dialogue makes clear that any deliberate mental act — including applying the most refined Dharma concepts — constitutes a kind of constructive striving that, from the standpoint of a mind equal to space, is itself a form of turbidity. The irony is intentional: even correct Dharma analysis is "striving with exertion" when contrasted with the non-fabricating mind.

The phrase rendered "optical illusion" translates mig yor, the classic example of seeing a double moon or floaters in vision, a standard simile in Buddhist epistemology.

- The young god who speaks to the great śrāvakas is named ར་རྩ་འགྲོ་བཤད་པུ་སྐྱིད་, which I have rendered as Ratnacandra following a plausible reading, but the name could also be rendered simply as "the young god of supreme skillfulness" or left as Ratnacandra pending verification against a Sanskrit or other witness. The Tibetan literally means something like "the young god of supreme prowess of mind." Readers should note this is a proper name being interpreted; if a different standard rendering exists in published translations of this text, that should be preferred.

The phrase 二而不等, literally "the unequal is two," I have rendered as "the unequal is duality," understanding it to gloss what is not brought into equipoise as subject-object duality. This interpretation follows the immediate context but is not without ambiguity.

- The name translated as "Gāṅgaputra" renders གངས་ཀྱི་ཕུ་རྒྱལ་, which is literally "the son of the river," a somewhat unusual epithet. The Tibetan བཱི་ཏྭ་པུ་རྒྱལ་ may be a rendering of a Sanskrit name meaning "son of Maitrī" or it may reflect a different tradition; the identification is not entirely certain, but the literal rendering is preserved.

The phrase **अविनाशकृत्याः**, rendered "uninterrupted transgressions," refers to the five acts of immediate retribution (pañcānantarya), the gravest possible misdeeds. The doctrinal point is that because awakening has no arising by intrinsic nature, it is like those acts in being beyond ordinary karmic calculation — a deliberately provocative formulation characteristic of this text's style.

Nāmāgra (नामाग्र) and Gāṅgaputra (गाङ्गपुत्र) are minor figures not uniformly attested across editions; their precise Sanskrit names cannot be confirmed with certainty.

- The passage plays on the Tibetan term *lhag pa'i nga rgyal*, which in ordinary Buddhist usage means "superior conceit" or "overestimation" — a kind of hubris. Here Mañjuśrī deliberately subverts this by redefining it as the bodhisattva's aspiration to buddhahood that surpasses the attainments of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. This rhetorical strategy, common in Mahāyāna sūtra literature, intentionally shocks the śrāvaka audience before the redefinition is supplied. The translation preserves this tension rather than smoothing it over.

The simile attributed to Śāriputra contrasts a "dark pool" with a superior pond, and then the ocean with the mass of water below it: in both cases, the lesser serves as the reference point against which the greater shines. The doctrinal point is that śrāvakas are supreme among their own kind, yet the bodhisattva surpasses them entirely.

- The name of the second divine youth is rendered in Tibetan as Rabrtsal Sems, which appears to be a proper name meaning something like "Keen-Minded" or "Supremely Skilled Mind." No Sanskrit equivalent is recoverable from context, so it has been given with a gloss in parentheses.

The phrase rendered "are expressible and rest upon space" translates mngon par skabs yod pa dang nam mkha' la rten pa, which is somewhat compressed. The first element suggests something like "being accessible to expression" or "having occasion to manifest," and the second that phenomena are ultimately grounded in open, unobstructed space. The translation attempts a readable rendering while preserving both ideas; this phrasing is genuinely difficult and the interpretation is not certain.

- The phrase rendered "awakening to the root ground of those very afflictions" translates a construction meaning something like "fully understanding the underlying ground or root-location of those afflictions" — the doctrinal point being that a buddha's realization penetrates afflictions to their very root, which is emptiness, rather than simply eliminating them as objects of abandonment. This is a nuanced Mahāyāna position and the rendering attempts to preserve that precision.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence with the analogy of the arrow in flight; the translation faithfully renders it to that point. The analogy is a well-known Mahāyāna trope illustrating the bodhisattva's non-abiding (apratīṣṭhita) between the conditioned and unconditioned, paralleling the doctrine of apratīṣṭhitanirvāṇa (non-abiding nirvāṇa).

The phrase rendered "does not rely on others" (gzhan gyi dring mi 'jog) literally means "does not place one's weight on another," conveying independence of spiritual verification rather than social isolation.

- The final string of participial clauses ends mid-sentence in the source, continuing from the preceding passage's structural pattern of an unfinished analogy. The translation preserves this open-ended quality as in the Tibetan.

The phrase rendered "performs the work of fully employing" translates yongs su spyad pa'i las byed pa, which carries the sense of thoroughly practicing or enacting the qualities of; the translation captures the deliberate paradox of simultaneously inhabiting both saṃsāra and nirvāṇa.

The phrase "'pho ba med pas 'byung bar byed" literally means "causes arising through the absence of transference or transition," referring to the bodhisattva's taking of rebirth without an actual transmigrating entity; this is a standard Madhyamaka-inflected doctrinal point preserved in the rendering.

- The passage on the six perfections accomplished through their apparent opposites is a classic example of the bodhisattva's non-dual skillful means: the perfections are described as being realized paradoxically through their own obstructions, a teaching on the non-abandonment of saṃsāric conditions in service of beings. This is a deliberate rhetorical inversion, not a textual error.

The name of the divine youth, rendered here as Rabrtsal, is a Tibetan name meaning "Exuberant" or "Masterful Mind." A Sanskrit equivalent is not recoverable from the text.

The phrase "not touching the liberation of the śrāvakas" means the bodhisattva does not settle into or appropriate the one-sided liberation of the śrāvaka path, keeping the Mahāyāna trajectory intact.

- The phrase rendered "the two lower grounds" translates a reference to the two inferior vehicles, not the bodhisattva grounds (bhūmi); the Tibetan "sa gnyis po dag" in context means

the two vehicles of hearers and solitary buddhas, which a bodhisattva should not delight in even in dreams — this is a slightly unusual usage of "sa" and merits noting. The phrase "knowledge of liberation" renders "rnam par grol ba shes pa," which is a technical term sometimes rendered "knowledge of liberation" or "liberating knowledge" — it refers to the wisdom that knows one is free, cognate with the Pāli vimutti-ñāṇa.

- The phrase rendered "does not cause them to arrive at that thorough knowledge for its own sake" is compressed in the Tibetan and could alternatively be read as "does not make that thorough knowing into a thorough knowing" — meaning bodhisattvas teach the exhaustive comprehension of the aggregates etc. to others without themselves fixating on or completing that comprehension as a personal attainment. The rendering chosen reflects this doctrinal nuance.
- The passage's enumeration of the Four Reliances (rely on meaning not letter, wisdom not ordinary knowing, definitive sūtras not provisional ones, Dharma not persons) appears in a slightly unconventional order here compared with standard canonical listings; the translation follows the Tibetan sequence exactly.

The phrase rendered "the eighth" for "brgyad pa ma yin pa" refers to the person who has entered the eighth stage of the path of a śrāvaka, i.e., the one established in the fruit of stream-entry before its full realization; it is a technical term from Abhidharma enumerations of the eight noble individuals. This is glossed inline as "(the eighth)" to preserve the reference without disrupting the flow.

- The phrase rendered "idle talk of the world" translates a term that literally means something like "worldly proclamation-talk" or "worldly advertising-speech," suggesting vain or boastful speech aimed at worldly ends. The rendering captures the doctrinal contrast intended.

The "seven noble riches" refers to the standard list of faith, ethical discipline, generosity, learning, conscientiousness, moral shame, and wisdom — a well-attested canonical enumeration.

The "eight states of non-leisure" refers to the eight inopportune conditions for Dharma practice, and "perfect leisure and excellence" renders the technical term for the freedoms and endowments of a precious human rebirth.

- The passage presents a sustained reinterpretation of the four stages of the śrāvaka path — stream-enterer, once-returned, non-returner, and arhat — in terms of bodhisattva practice. Mañjuśrī systematically redeploys the technical vocabulary of each stage to describe a bodhisattva who embodies the qualities from a Mahāyāna perspective rather than the Foundational Vehicle one. The phrase rendered "does not actually sever saṃsāra itself" reflects the bodhisattva ideal of remaining in saṃsāra for the benefit of beings while cutting off the suffering streams within it. The phrase rendered "whose deeds are not yet finalized" for "མ་གྲོན་སྤྱིར་བཏང་།" in the non-returner section contrasts with "whose deeds are finalized" in the same section, reflecting the paradox that the bodhisattva non-returner has not concluded all activities until buddha-qualities are perfected, yet is at the same time described as having finalized deeds in a different sense — likely referring to the irreversibility of the bodhisattva commitment. This apparent tension is intrinsic to the text's rhetorical strategy.
- The phrase rendered "the Dharma of what has not been heard" follows the Tibetan "ma thos pa'i chos," which could mean either Dharma that has not been heard by beings before, or the unheard Dharma in the sense of the unprecedented teaching. The former reading is adopted as more contextually natural in this enumeration of a bodhisattva-śrāvaka's qualities.

The phrase "primordially solitary" renders "gzod ma nas dben pa nyid," where "dben pa" literally means "solitary, secluded, empty of inherent presence." It is used here in a philosophical sense close to emptiness or utter aloneness from the very beginning; some

- The phrase rendered "the unwavering" translates a term literally meaning "the uninterrupted" or "the heinous" — the Tibetan མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་ here is ambiguous: it can mean the five acts of immediate retribution (the ānantarya-karmas) or, more abstractly, "that which is without boundary or interval." In this doctrinal context, where awakening is said to be "equal" to the most extreme phenomena (afflictions, inversions, etc.), the sense is almost certainly a Mahāyāna paradox: awakening is non-different from even the five acts of immediate retribution in its ultimate equanimity. The translation "the unwavering" captures the rhetorical register without importing a specific technical referent mid-sentence; a reader should be aware this likely alludes to the ānantarya-karmas.

The expression "sees the ultimate limit clearly and well" renders "མཐོང་པོར་གྱི་འཕགས་ཀྱི་ལྷན་ཆེན་ལ་བཞུགས་པ།," where "མཐོང་པོར་གྱི་འཕགས་ཀྱི་ལྷན་ཆེན་ལ་བཞུགས་པ།" can mean either "the true limit" or "the real extreme," pointing to direct realization of ultimate reality as the ground of the bodhisattva's imperturbability.

The phrase rendered "the three fires" refers to the standard Buddhist image of the fires of attachment, aversion, and delusion.

- The phrase rendered "hollow to the very marrow" translates a somewhat compressed expression meaning something like "not truly real, right down to the core." The Tibetan conveys an idiomatic sense of utter insubstantiality, and this rendering captures the intended force. The exact reading is not in dispute doctrinally, only in its precise colloquial register.

- The name rendered as "Prabhalamanas" is a back-translation of the Tibetan lha'i bu rab rtsal sems, meaning something like "the son of the gods whose mind has excellent skill or brilliance." The Sanskrit original, if it exists, has not been consulted here, and listeners should be aware this name rendering is approximate.

- The "sixty-two kinds of wrong views" refers to the standard ancient Indian enumeration of sixty-two false speculative views catalogued in texts such as the *Brahmajālasūtra*. The claim that these views, along with obscurations and non-virtues, constitute the bodhisattva's path is a characteristically paradoxical Mahāyāna formulation: because a bodhisattva seeks these things within sentient beings, and finds upon searching that neither the beings nor their afflictions have any findable inherent existence, the very search becomes the path. This is not antinomianism but a statement about the non-findability of afflictions under analysis.

- The phrase rendered "understanding through the summit of the head" (mgo smos pas go ba) and "understanding through elaboration" (rnam par spros pas go ba) are unusual idioms. The first likely refers to a superlative or paramount form of understanding — grasping something from its very pinnacle or apex — while the second refers to understanding by means of discursive unfolding or analytical elaboration. The dialogue is cut off mid-answer on the second question, which is intentional as the passage ends there. These are technical or semi-proverbial expressions whose precise doctrinal referent is not entirely transparent from context alone.
- The passage contains what appears to be a textual irregularity: Mañjuśrī's response to the statement about sentient beings who will develop faith being rare is recorded as "Mañjuśrī replied —" followed immediately by the son of the gods speaking again, suggesting either a scribal omission in the Tibetan or that Mañjuśrī's reply is itself the following exchange, which was immediately prompted by the son of the gods. The translation preserves this anomaly faithfully rather than smoothing it over.

The phrase rendered "set on the wrong course with respect to the task of liberating sentient beings" reflects a deliberate paradox: the bodhisattva is said to be on the wrong course precisely because he does not abandon sentient beings, which from the standpoint of personal liberation would be a deviation. This is a standard Mahāyāna doctrinal irony and is preserved as such.

- The phrase rendered "liberated through the equipoise of equanimity" translates a compound meaning liberation through the sameness or non-differentiation of the afflictions — that is, seeing attachment, aversion, and delusion as equal in their ultimate nature, which itself constitutes liberation. This is a distinctive tantric or Madhyamaka-inflected soteriological point and is preserved literally here.

King Prasenajit (Tibetan: rgyal po gsal rgyal) is the king of Kosala, a major lay supporter of the Buddha in the canonical literature; the name is kept in its standard Sanskrit form.

The term rendered "non-arising of phenomena" is the standard rendering of anutpattikadharmakṣānti, the bodhisattva's patient acceptance or direct insight into the fact that phenomena have no ultimate arising — a key attainment on the bodhisattva path.

- The Tibetan list of eight classes of beings includes gandharvas rendered here as "scent-eaters" (their literal Tibetan etymology), but since this is TTS output I have given the Sanskrit name with a brief gloss. Garuḍas are similarly glossed for a listening audience.

The phrase "approximately two thousand" translates གཞི་ལྷན་གྱི་ཡི་ཤུ་ལྷན་གྱི་ཡི་ཤུ་གྱི་ཡི་ཤུ་, where གཞི་ signals approximation.

- The name of the young god rendered as "Supraṭiṣṭhitamati" is a back-reconstruction from the Tibetan "Rab rtsa་་ sems" meaning something like "Supremely Determined Mind" or "Well-Established Intention." The standard Sanskrit equivalent in this sūtra's tradition is Supraṭiṣṭhitamati; the rendering is consistent with known attestations of this text.

The sixfold trembling of the earth is a standard canonical motif and is rendered without elaboration as it would be recognized by the intended audience.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source as supplied; the translation mirrors this exactly.

- The colophon name རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷན་གྱི་ཡི་ཤུ་ལྷན་གྱི་ཡི་ཤུ་གྱི་ཡི་ཤུ་ is rendered as "The Questions of the Son of the Gods Devapramuktamanas" — this Sanskrit title reconstruction is approximate. The Tibetan means literally "Questions of the Son of the Gods Finest-Skillful-Mind," and the Sanskrit title behind this Tibetan is not fully certain. The translation preserves a plausible reconstruction for identification purposes.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.